



Neural Networks

Data Science and
Management

Corso di Laurea Magistrale in
Ingegneria Gestionale

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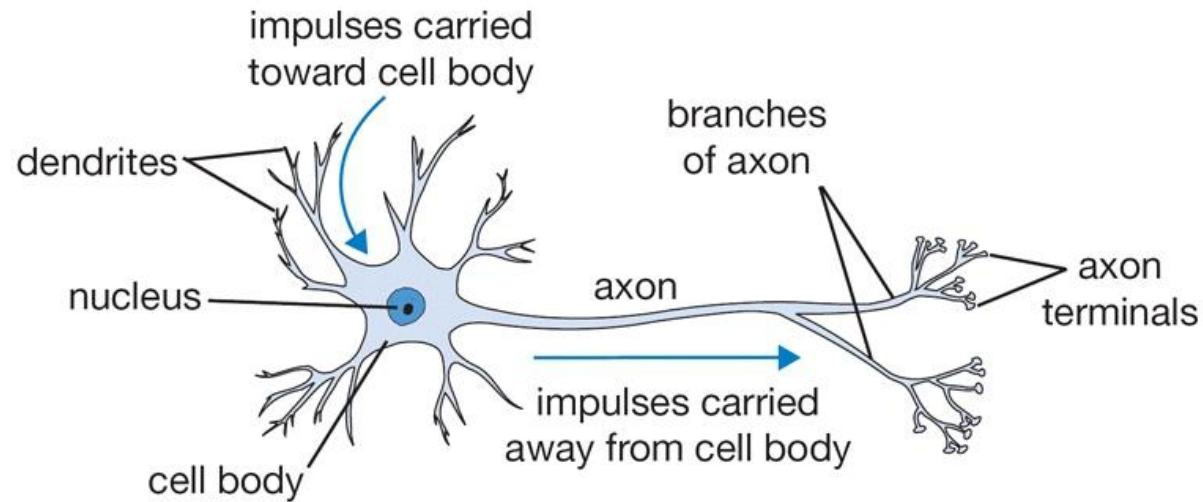
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- Neural Networks
- Backpropagation
- Activation Function
- Hyperparameters
- Learning process

Neural Networks

Biologically inspired by the human brain

- Interconnected cells, signal propagation (synapses)

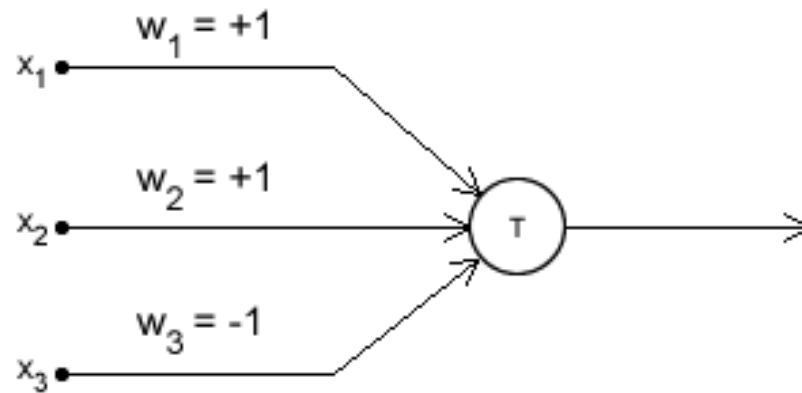


[Image from <http://cs231n.github.io/>]

Neural Networks

The idea of artificial neuron dates back to 1940s

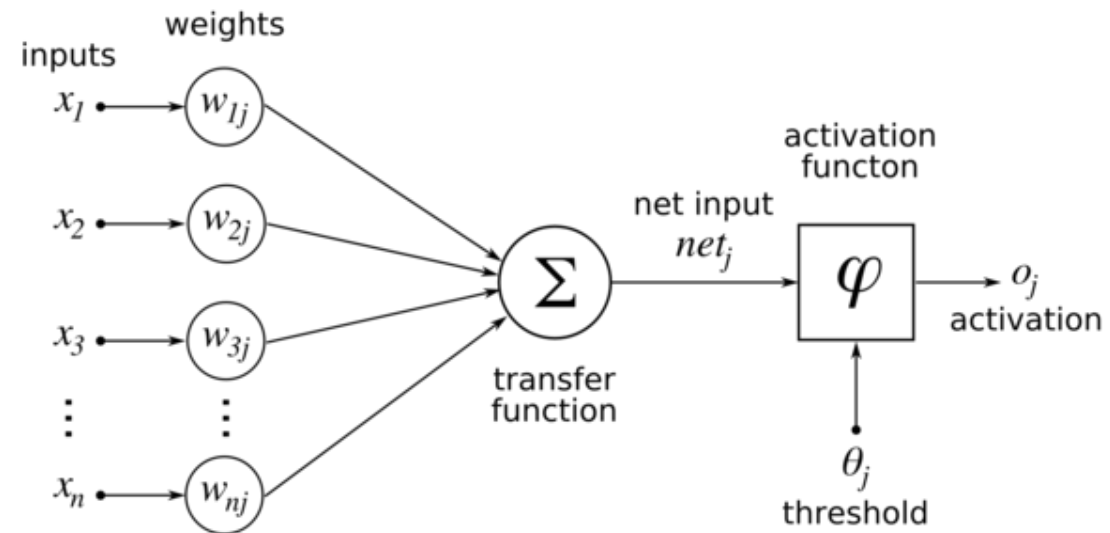
- 1943: McCulloch and Pitts



[Image from <http://aishack.in>]

Neural Networks

- 1958: Rosenblatt's perceptron



[Image from Wikipedia]

Perceptron

How to learn parameters

- Define a **loss** function to be **minimized**
- Typically the **classification error** on the training set

$$E(\beta, \mathcal{D}) = \sum_{(x_i, y_i) \in \mathcal{D}} \ell(y_i, f(x_i))$$

- How can we **minimize** this error?

Perceptron



For the classic perceptron the **loss function** is defined as:

$$\ell(y_i, f(x_i)) = -y_i f(x_i)$$

Idea: **different signs** between target and prediction imply **wrong classifications**, so we should correct them

Perceptron

Gradient descent algorithm

- Compute the **gradient** of error function wrt parameters
- **Iterate** until gradient is approximately zero

$$\beta^i = \beta^{i-1} - \eta \nabla E(\beta, \mathcal{D})$$

**i IS THE
ITERATION**

- η is called the **learning rate**

Perceptron



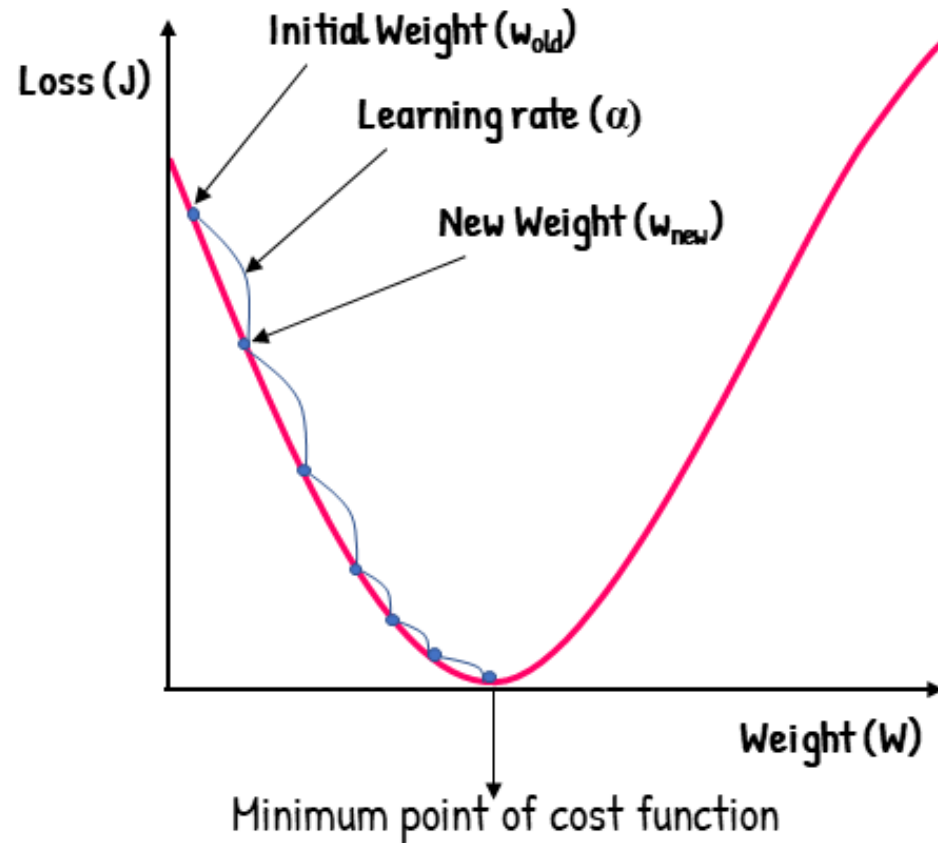
The learning rate is a **crucial** parameter

- Too **small** implies slow **convergence**
- Too **high** causes **instability**
- There exist algorithms to **adapt it during training**

Guarantee to reach a **local minimum** of the error function

Backpropagation

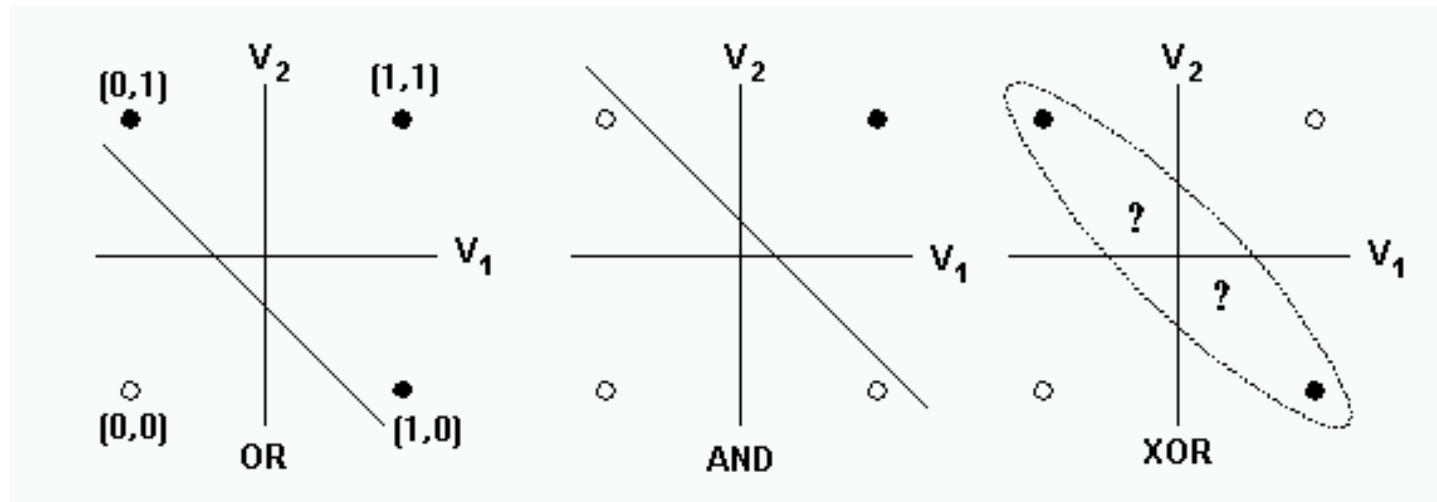
Gradient Descent



$$w_{new} = w_{old} - \alpha \frac{\delta J}{\delta w}$$

Neural Networks

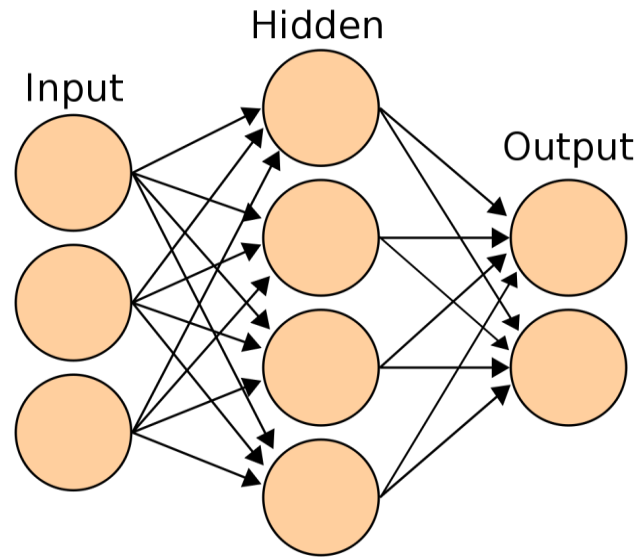
- 1969: Minsky & Papert: limits of the perceptron



[Image from colorado.edu]

Neural Networks

- 1970s-1980s: Multi-Layer Perceptron



[Image from Wikipedia]

Neural Networks



- 1970s-1980s: Multi-Layer Perceptron

The output of a node is the weighted sum of its inputs, to which an **activation function** is applied:

$$o_j^\ell = \sigma \left(\sum_{i=1}^m w_{ij}^\ell o_i^{\ell-1} \right)$$

The activation function must be non linear, otherwise multilayers are useless

Weights are learned so as to minimize the error on the output layer (e.g., the squared error)

This is called the **backpropagation algorithm**

Backpropagation

Backpropagation — Main ideas...

- Initialize the network with **random** weights
- Show the training examples to the network (**epoch**) and **adjust** the weights so that the output matches the desired output (**target**)
- Keep **iterating** over epochs until some **convergence criterion** is met (more on this later)

Backpropagation

Backpropagation — Main ideas...

- The learning phase exploits a **gradient descent** algorithm such as for the perceptron

$$w_{ij}^{t+1} = w_{ij}^t - \eta \frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}}$$

BATCH OR ONLINE AS FOR PERCEPTRON
(More on this later...)

Backpropagation - Loss

Loss functions (some examples for classification)

$y=1, p(y)=1$, correct example, $E = 0$
 $y=1, p(y)=0$, wrong example, $E = +\ln f$

- Binary cross-entropy

$$E = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N y_i \log(p(y_i)) + (1 - y_i) \log(1 - p(y_i))$$

- Multinomial cross-entropy / categorical cross-entropy

$$E = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N \sum_{j=1}^K y_{ij} \log(p(y_{ij}))$$

K = num. classes



Backpropagation - Output

Output nodes

- Binary classification (1 output node)

$$o^L = \sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$$

SIGMOID
(probability of class 1)

- Multinomial classification (k output nodes)

$$o_i^L = \frac{e^{z_i}}{\sum_{j=1}^K e^{z_j}}$$

SOFTMAX
(probabilities over classes)

Backpropagation - Loss

- Loss functions (some examples for regression)

Residual Sum of Squares (RSS)

$$RSS = \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2$$

where $\hat{y}_i$ is computed as

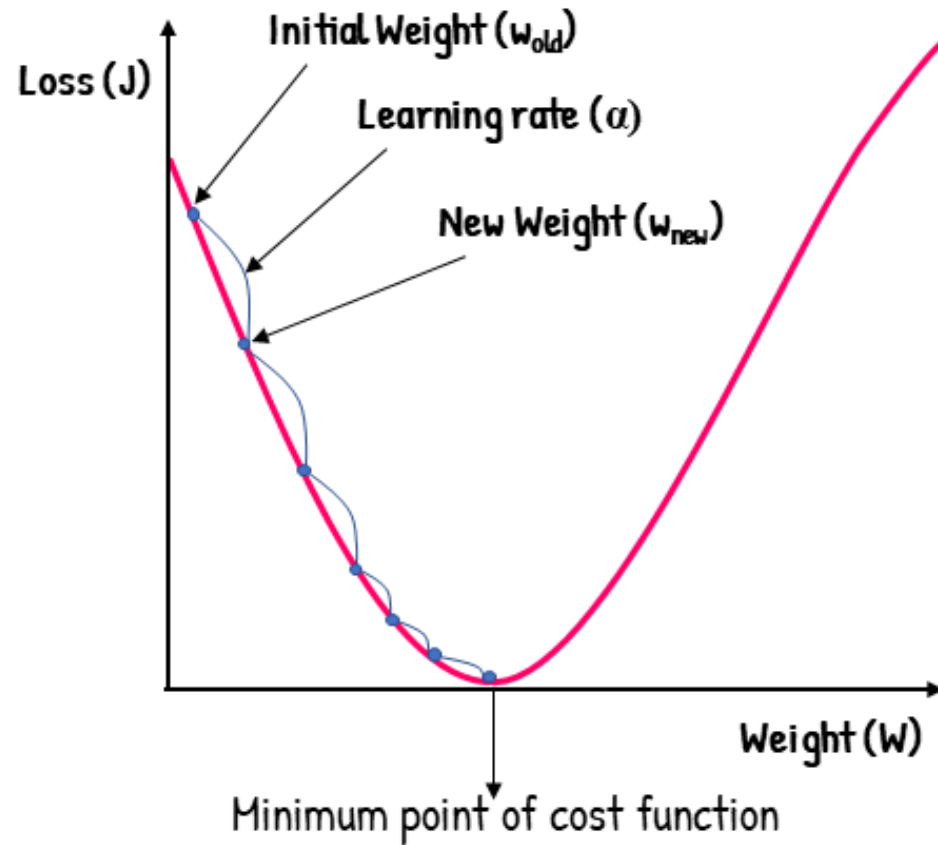
$$o_j^\ell = \sigma \left(\sum_{i=1}^m w_{ij}^\ell o_i^{\ell-1} \right)$$

$\hat{y}_i$ = last output

Last output can be sigmoid?

Backpropagation

Gradient Descent



$$w_{new} = w_{old} - \alpha \frac{\delta J}{\delta w}$$

Backpropagation

Backpropagation — High level code...

1. **init** network weights
2. **repeat**
3. **for each** training pair (x, y)
 - 3a. prediction = **compute output** (w, x)
 - 3b. **compute error** $(\text{prediction} - y)$ at the output units
 - 3c. **propagate** error from output layer to hidden layer
 - 3d. **propagate** error from hidden layer to input layer
 - 3e. update all weights by **gradient step**
4. **until** stopping criterion (more on this later)

Backpropagation

Batch vs. **stochastic** gradient descent

- In general, the gradient is obtained as the **sum** of gradients computed for all the **training examples**
- In principle, we could also update the vector of parameters **after each example** rather than after all the training set
- Update after each example is called **stochastic** update
- **Faster** training, which can help **avoiding** local minima
 - Helps avoiding positive and negative example cancelling each other
- **Mini-batch**

Activation functions

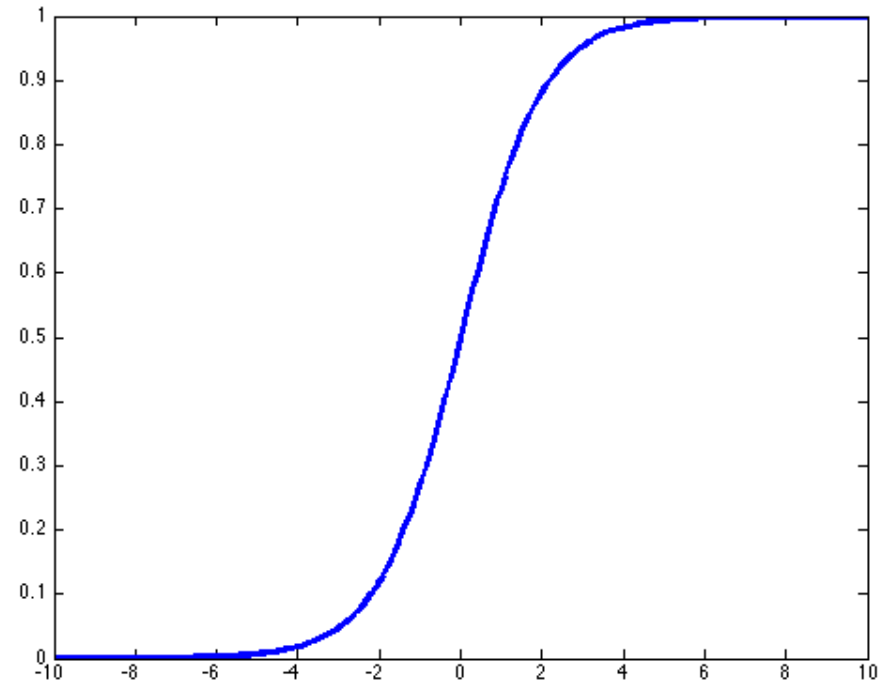
Examples of activation functions:

- Sigmoid
 - Hyperbolic Tangent (Tanh)
 - Rectifier (ReLU — Rectified Linear Unit)
 - ...
-
- CLASSIC MODELS
- DEEP MODELS

Activation functions

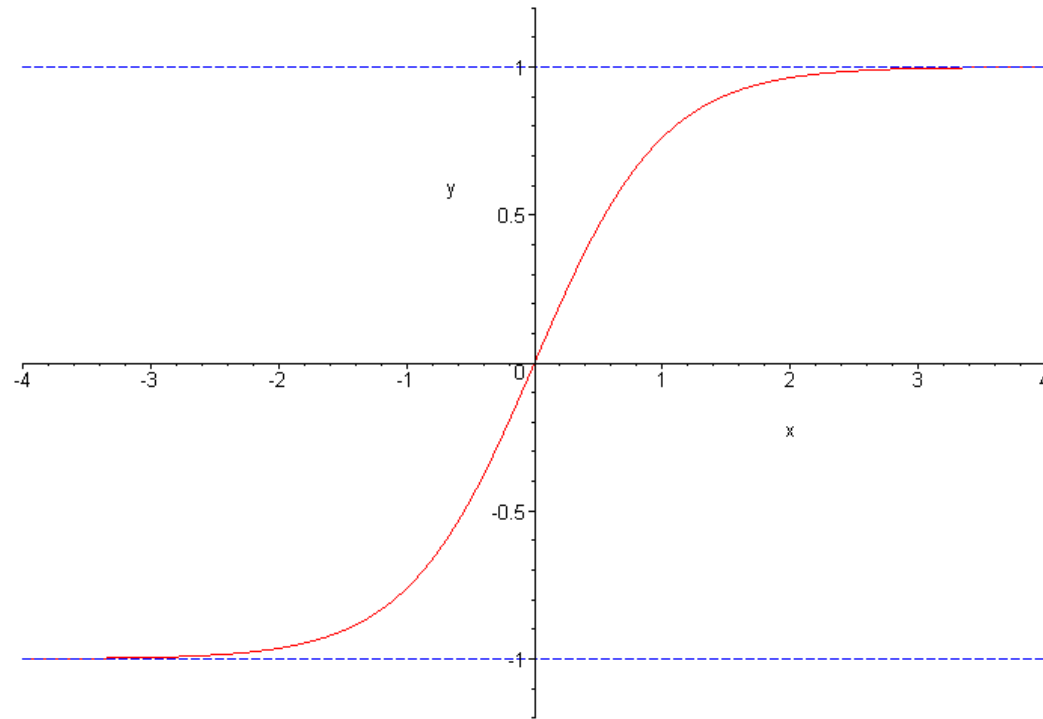
Sigmoid

$$\sigma(t) = \frac{1}{1+e^{-t}}$$



Neural Activation functions

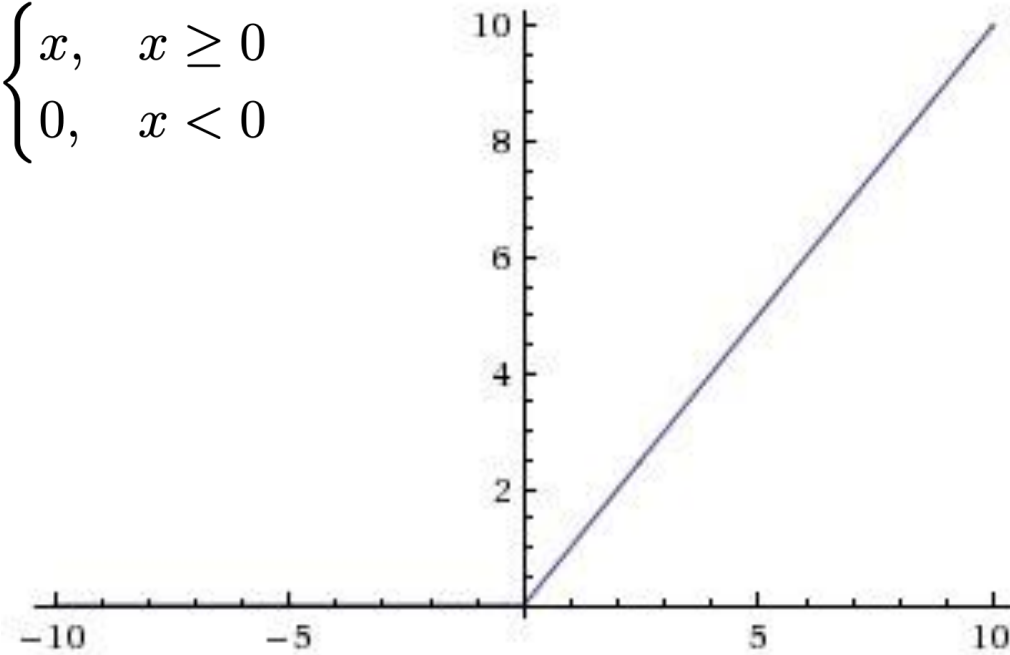
Hyperbolic Tangent



Activation functions

Rectifier

$$\text{ReLU}(x) = \begin{cases} x, & x \geq 0 \\ 0, & x < 0 \end{cases}$$



Non-linearity



These activation functions are all **non-linear**

Neural Networks can learn **non-linear dependencies** between input and output, **without any assumption** on the shape of the function

Often, networks with more layers (**deep learning**) are more powerful models (but learning is more costly)

Vanishing gradients



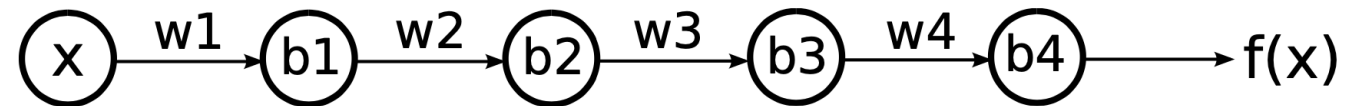
Networks with many (more than 1-2) hidden **layers** and **sigmoid** (a little less with **tanh...**) as activation function suffer of the problem of **vanishing gradients**

Gradients tend to **vanish** (or explode) as we backpropagate errors from the output to the input...

This is mainly due to **composition of derivatives...**

Vanishing gradients

Consider a neural network with 4 layers and a **single unit** in each layer.



We name x the input, w_j and b_j the weight and bias of layer j .
The output of each layer can be computed as:

$$z_j = \sigma(w_j z_{j-1} + b_j)$$

where $z_0 = x$.

[Example by M. Nielsen]

Vanishing gradients

chain rule

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{du} \frac{du}{dx}$$

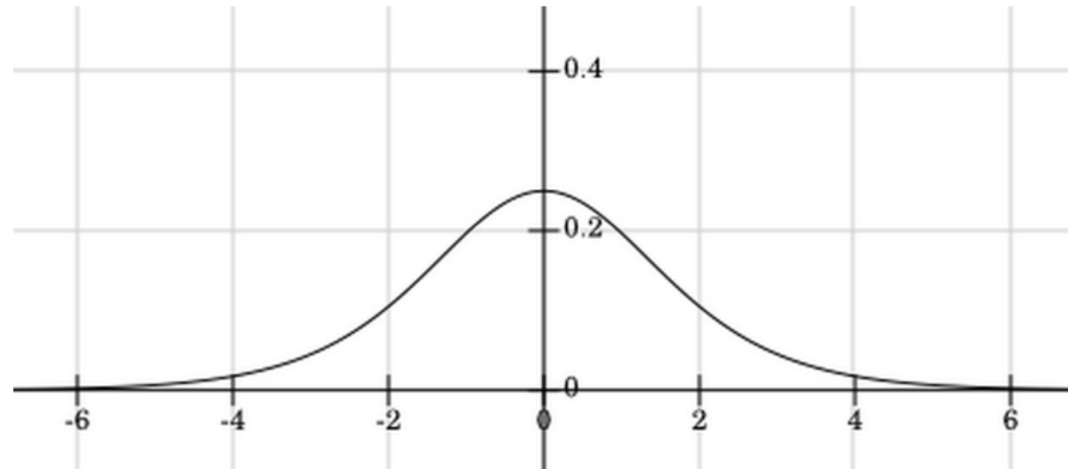
Let us compute the gradient of f with respect to b_1 and b_3 :

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial b_1} = \sigma'(z_1) \cdot w_2 \cdot \sigma'(z_2) \cdot w_3 \cdot \sigma'(z_3) \cdot w_4 \cdot \sigma'(z_4) \cdot \frac{\partial f}{\partial z_4}$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial b_3} = \sigma'(z_3) \cdot w_4 \cdot \sigma'(z_4) \cdot \frac{\partial f}{\partial z_4}$$

Vanishing gradients

If we now consider the derivative of the sigmoid function:



we have that, with typical weight initialization (randomly sampled from a Gaussian with mean 0 and standard deviation 1):

$$|w_j \sigma'(z_j)| < \frac{1}{4}$$

Vanishing gradients

Now going back to the gradient computation:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial b_1} = \sigma'(z_1) \cdot w_2 \cdot \sigma'(z_2) \cdot w_3 \cdot \sigma'(z_3) \cdot w_4 \cdot \sigma'(z_4) \cdot \frac{\partial f}{\partial z_4}$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial b_3} = \sigma'(z_3) \cdot w_4 \cdot \sigma'(z_4) \cdot \frac{\partial f}{\partial z_4}$$

Lower layers will tend to have either vanishing or exploding gradients !

Exhaustive analysis for Recurrent Neural Networks in [Hochreiter et al., 2001]

Hyperparameters



When creating a neural network, one has to choose:

- the number of **layers**
- the number of **hidden units** in each layer
- the **number of epochs**
- the **learning rate**...?

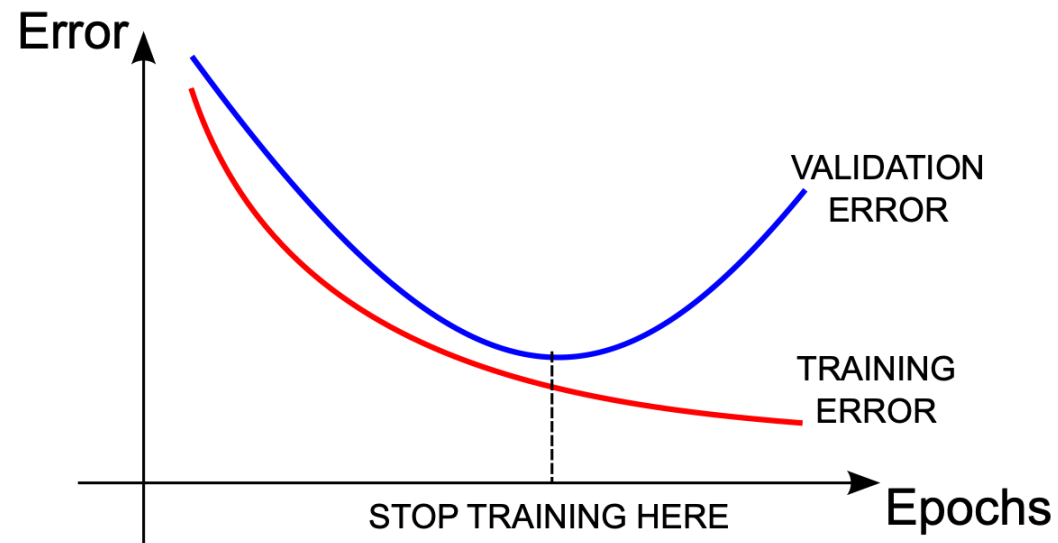
Hyperparameters optimization via validation set!

Hyperparameters

- The number of **hidden layers** has long been 1-2, but now much deeper networks are employed (but in that case **use ReLU activation**)
- The number of **hidden units** in each layer is a set of hyper-parameters that should be chosen according to the **validation** error

Overfitting

Given a network with fixed architecture, the **number of epochs** is chosen following the **early stopping** principle, using a **validation set**



Overfitting

One can also wait for a few epochs to see whether the validation error starts decreasing again (**patience**)

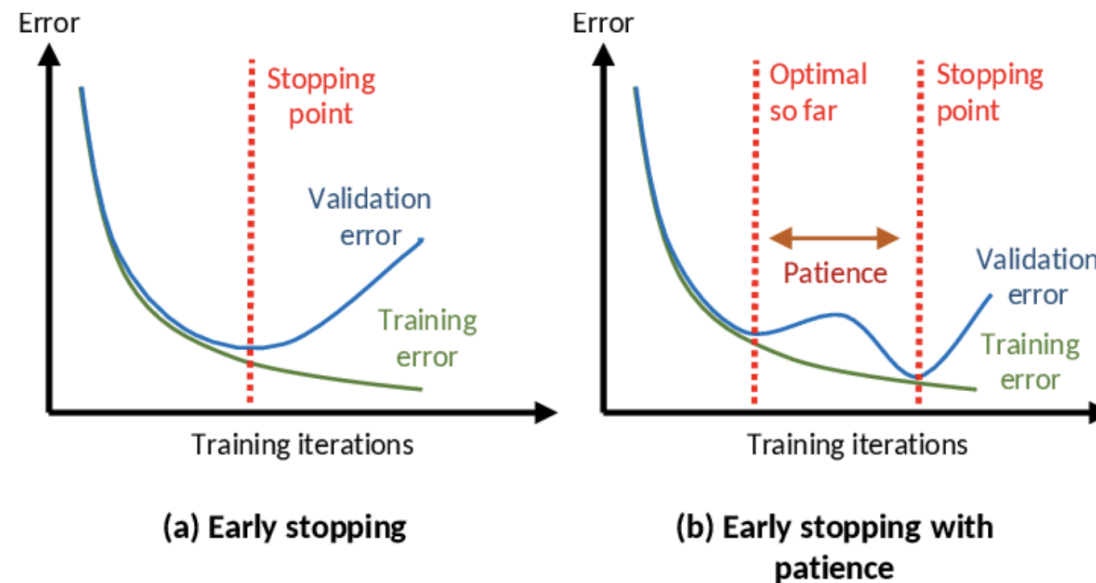


Figure by [Lore et al., 2016]

Learning process



Choosing the learning rate is **tricky**

- Too small: slow convergence
- Too large: divergence (numerically unstable)

This simple method is **obsolete**, we have nowadays more sophisticated optimizers that drive learning
The key idea is to **adjust** the learning rate across the epochs, and have a different one for **each** parameter

Learning process



Stochastic Gradient Descent

$$w_{ij}^{t+1} = w_{ij}^t - \eta \frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}}$$

Momentum

$$w_{ij}^{t+1} = w_{ij}^t - \eta \frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}} - \mu \left(\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}} \right)^{t-1}$$

Learning process

Adam

Key idea: one learning rate for each parameter!

The diagram illustrates the Adam optimizer's update rules. It features three equations with blue arrows pointing to specific components:
1. The top equation, $w_{t+1} = w_t + \Delta w_t$, shows the weight update.
2. The middle equation, $\Delta w_t = -\eta \frac{\nu_t}{\sqrt{s_t + \epsilon}} g_t$, shows the calculation of the weight change. A blue arrow from the text 'INITIAL LEARNING RATE' points to the η term. Another blue arrow from the text 'GRADIENT' points to the g_t term.
3. The bottom equation, $s_t = \beta_2 s_{t-1} - (1 - \beta_2) g_t^2$, shows the update of the squared gradient average. A blue arrow from the text 'EXPONENTIAL AVERAGE OF SQUARES OF GRADIENTS' points to this equation.
A third blue arrow from the text 'GRADIENT' also points to the ν_t term in the middle equation.
To the right of the equations, a blue text block states: 'THIS IS THE MOST WIDELY EMPLOYED OPTIMIZER NOWADAYS'.

$$w_{t+1} = w_t + \Delta w_t$$
$$\Delta w_t = -\eta \frac{\nu_t}{\sqrt{s_t + \epsilon}} g_t$$
$$\nu_t = \beta_1 \nu_{t-1} - (1 - \beta_1) g_t$$
$$s_t = \beta_2 s_{t-1} - (1 - \beta_2) g_t^2$$

INITIAL LEARNING RATE

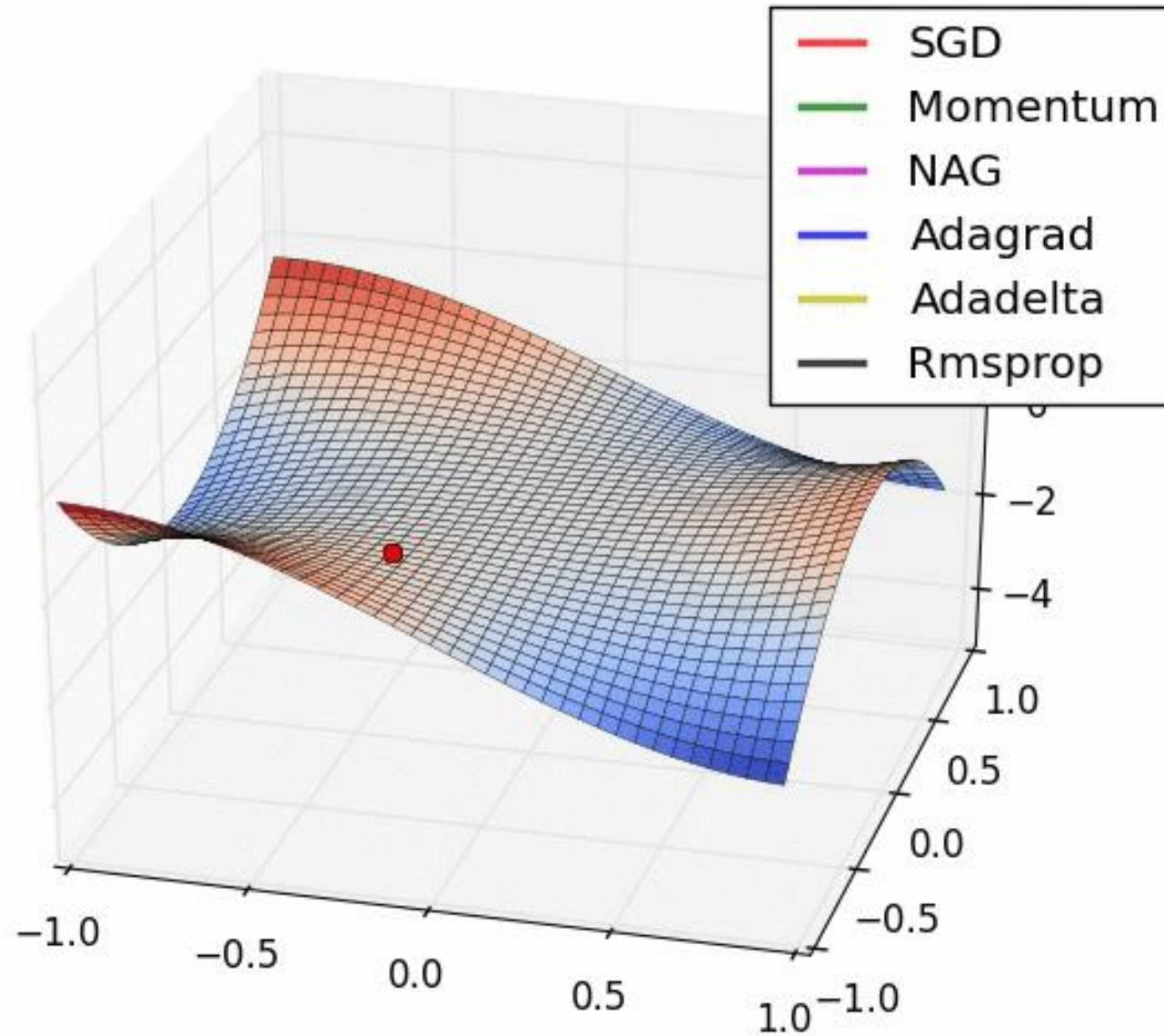
GRADIENT

EXPONENTIAL AVERAGE OF SQUARES OF GRADIENTS

THIS IS THE MOST WIDELY EMPLOYED OPTIMIZER NOWADAYS

<https://towardsdatascience.com/a-visual-explanation-of-gradient-descent-methods-momentum-adagrad-rmsprop-adam-f898b102325c>

SGd vs Momentum vs. Rmsprop



Neural Networks



Some tricks of the trade

- One-hot encoding
- Input range and standardization (zero-mean input)
- Smart weight initialization

Many packages for neural network with Python

- Scikit-learn (limited)
- Keras
- Tensorflow
- PyTorch

Deep Learning

- Intro
- Convolutional Networks
- Autoencoders
- RNN - LSTM

Deep Learning

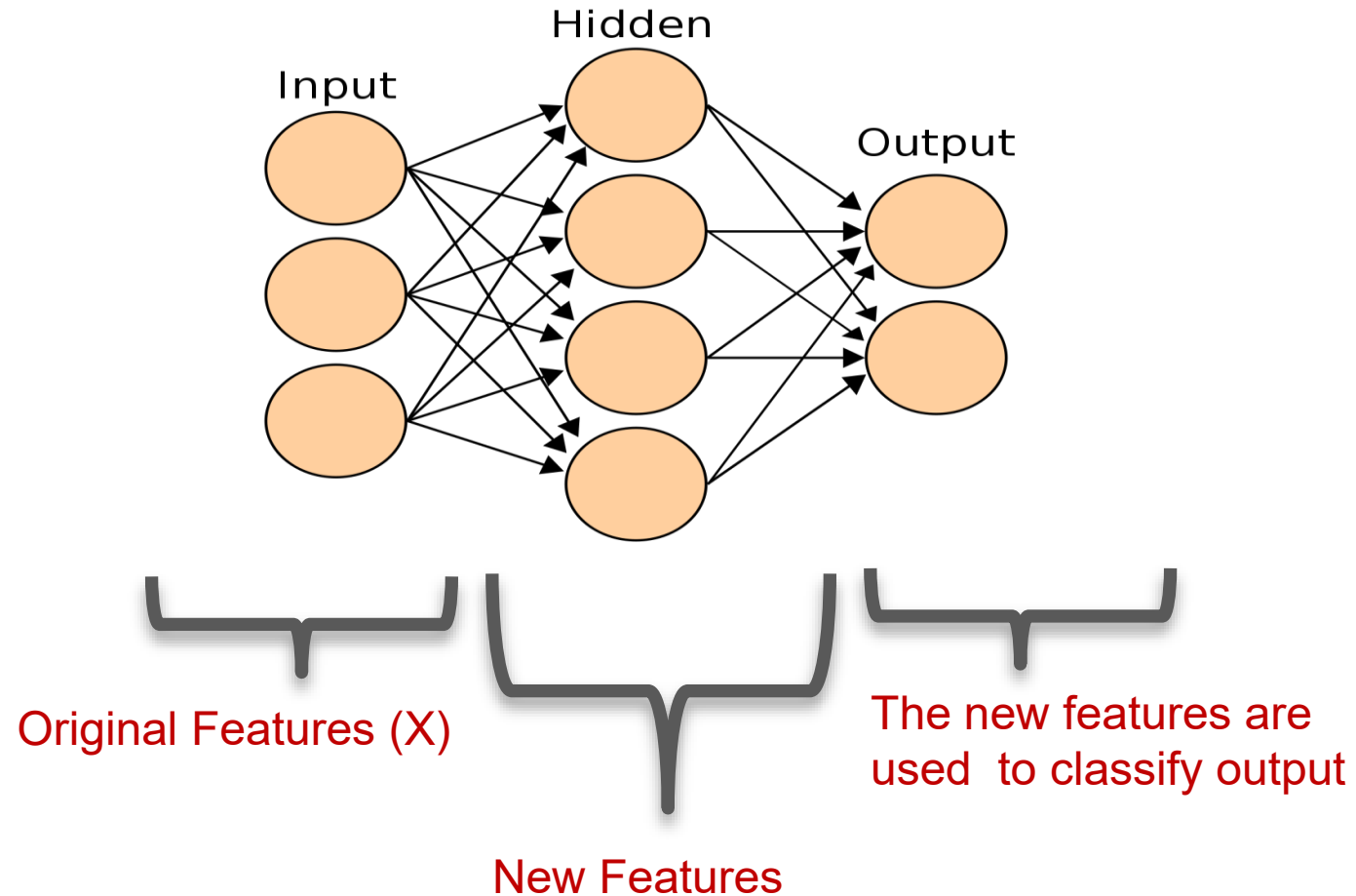


Deep learning is a **hot topic** in artificial intelligence and probably in computer science in general

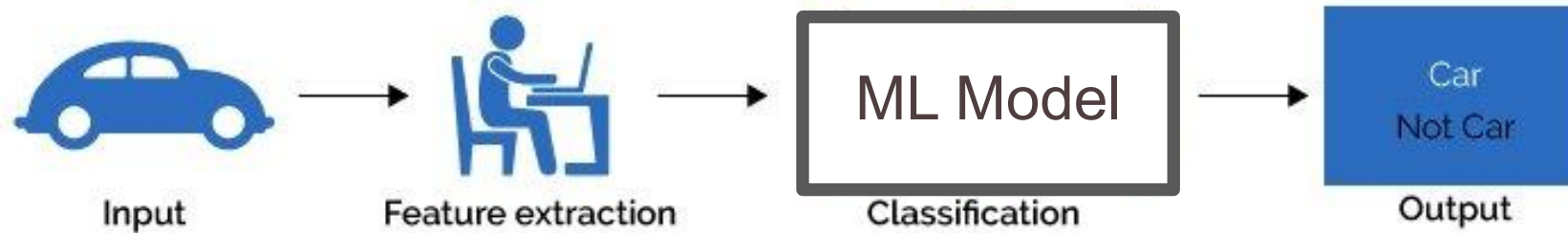
It does **not** mean just “neural networks with many layers” but it includes a wide collection of **architectures (i.e. neurons’ configuration)** useful for many purposes.

- Convolutional neural networks
- Recurrent neural networks
- Recursive neural networks
- Attention-based networks
- Transformers
- ...

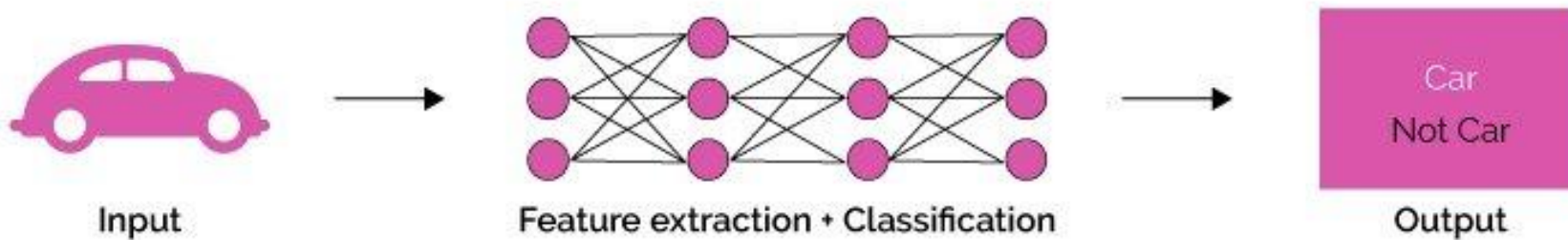
Feature Creation



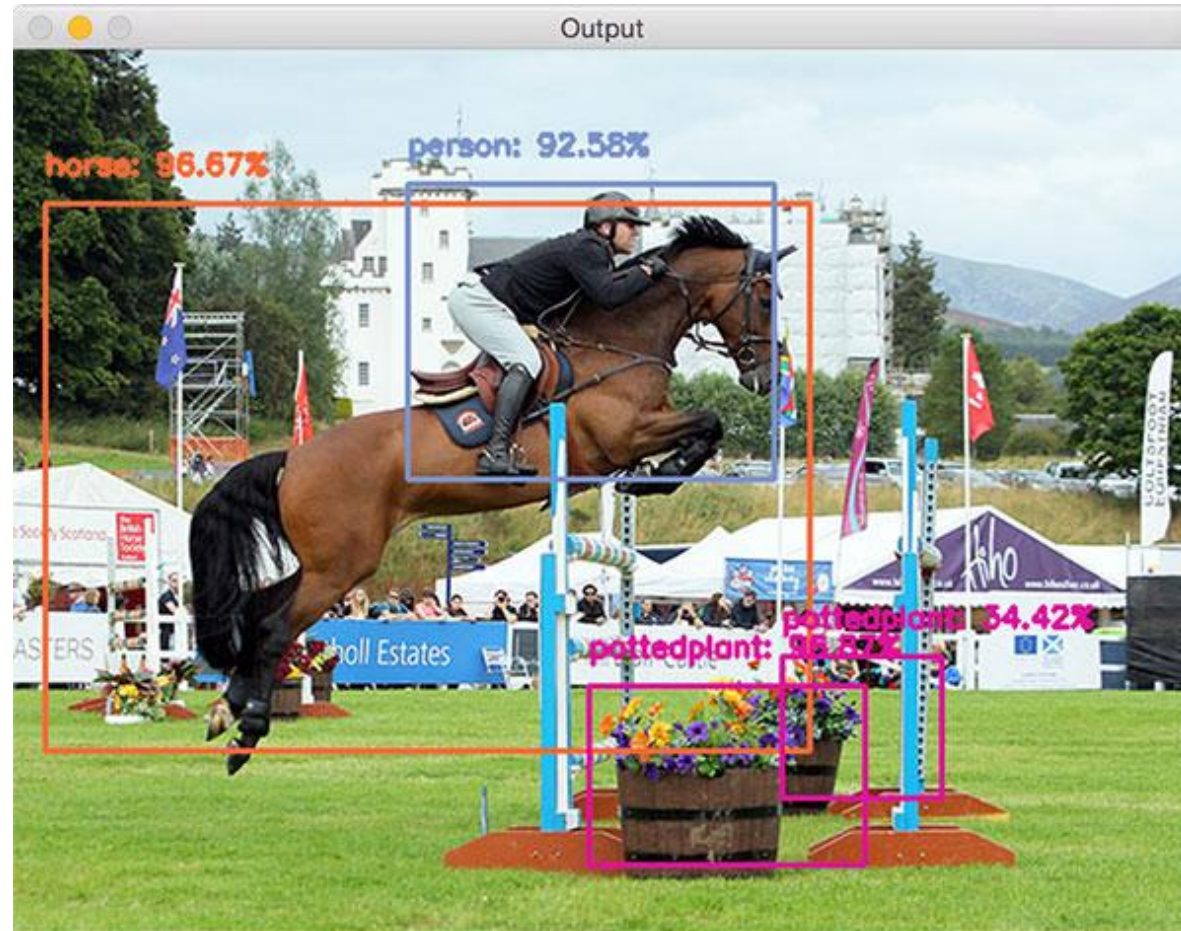
Machine Learning



Neural network / deep learning



Convolutional Neural Networks



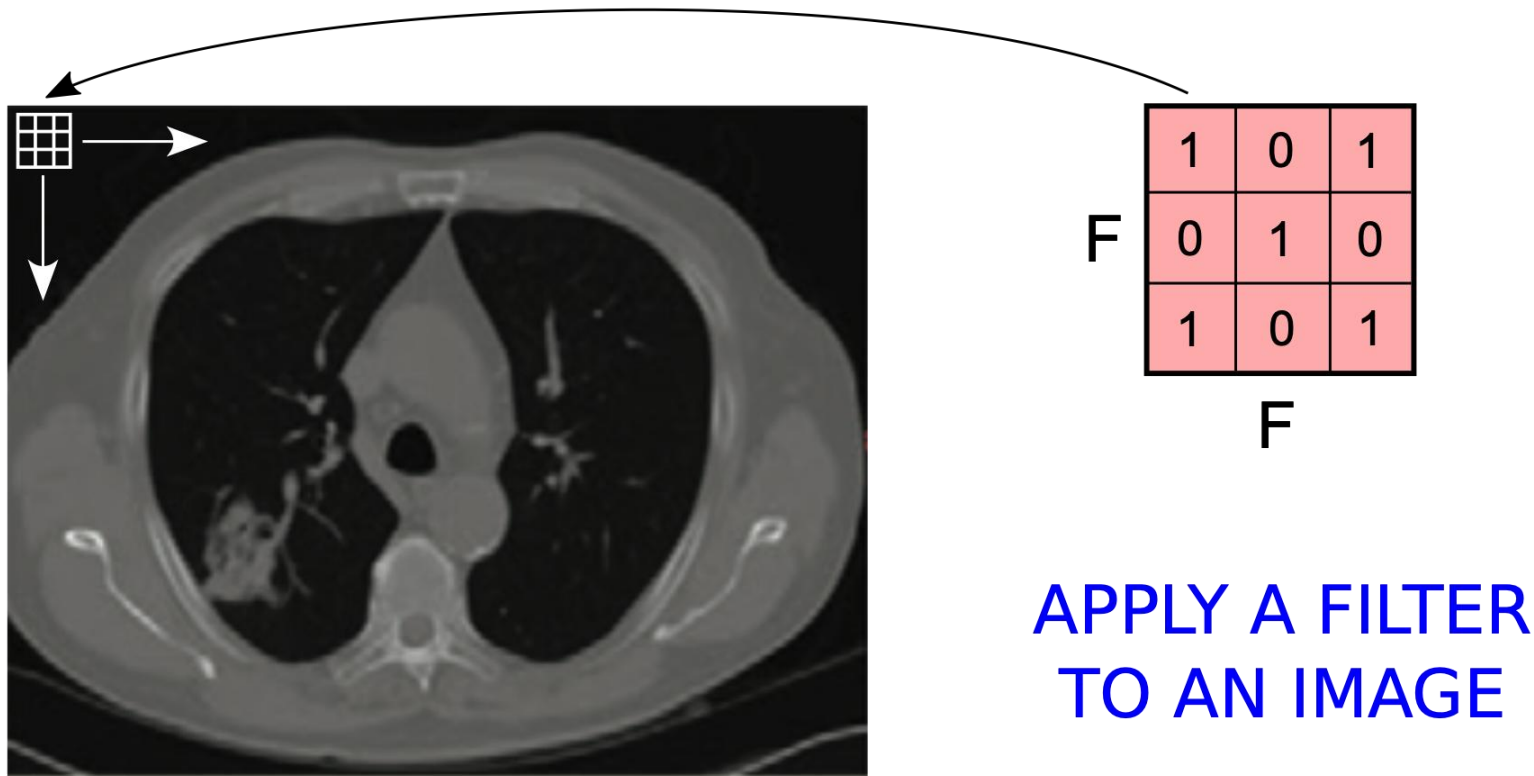
Convolutional Neural Networks



One of the most **widely** used deep network models

- First idea **dates back** to the 80s-90s!!!
 - Initially designed to classify **images**
 - Later on extended to **other** inputs (e.g., text)
-
- I could also apply MLP to images, but I'd lose geometry information

Convolutional Neural Networks



Convolutional Neural Networks

1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	0	0
0 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1	0
0 _{x1}	0 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1	1
0	0	1	1	0
0	1	1	0	0

Image

4		

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	0 _{x1}	0
0	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	0
0	0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1
0	0	1	1	0
0	1	1	0	0

Image

4	3	

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1	1 _{x1}	0 _{x0}	0 _{x1}
0	1	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	0 _{x0}
0	0	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}
0	0	1	1	0
0	1	1	0	0

Image

4	3	4

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1	1	0	0
0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1	0
0 _{x0}	0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1	1
0 _{x1}	0 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1	0
0	1	1	0	0

Image

4	3	4
2		

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1	1	0	0
0	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	0
0	0 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1
0	0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	0
0	1	1	0	0

Image

4	3	4
2	4	

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1	1	0	0
0	1	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	0 _{x1}
0	0	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}
0	0	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	0 _{x1}
0	1	1	0	0

Image

4	3	4
2	4	3

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1	1	0	0
0	1	1	1	0
0 _{x1}	0 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1	1
0 _{x0}	0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1	0
0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	0	0

Image

4	3	4
2	4	3
2		

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

1	1	1	0	0
0	1	1	1	0
0	0 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1
0	0 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	0
0	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	0 _{x1}	0

Image

4	3	4
2	4	3
2	3	

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks

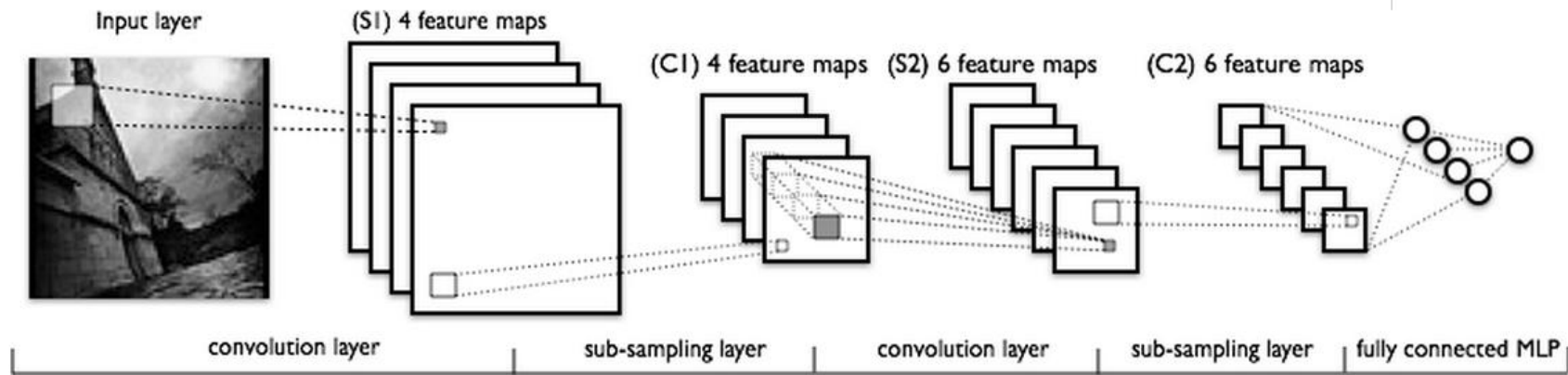
1	1	1	0	0
0	1	1	1	0
0	0	1 _{x1}	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}
0	0	1 _{x0}	1 _{x1}	0 _{x0}
0	1	1 _{x1}	0 _{x0}	0 _{x1}

Image

4	3	4
2	4	3
2	3	4

Convolved
Feature

Convolutional Neural Networks



CNNs are **stacks** of (convolution) layers

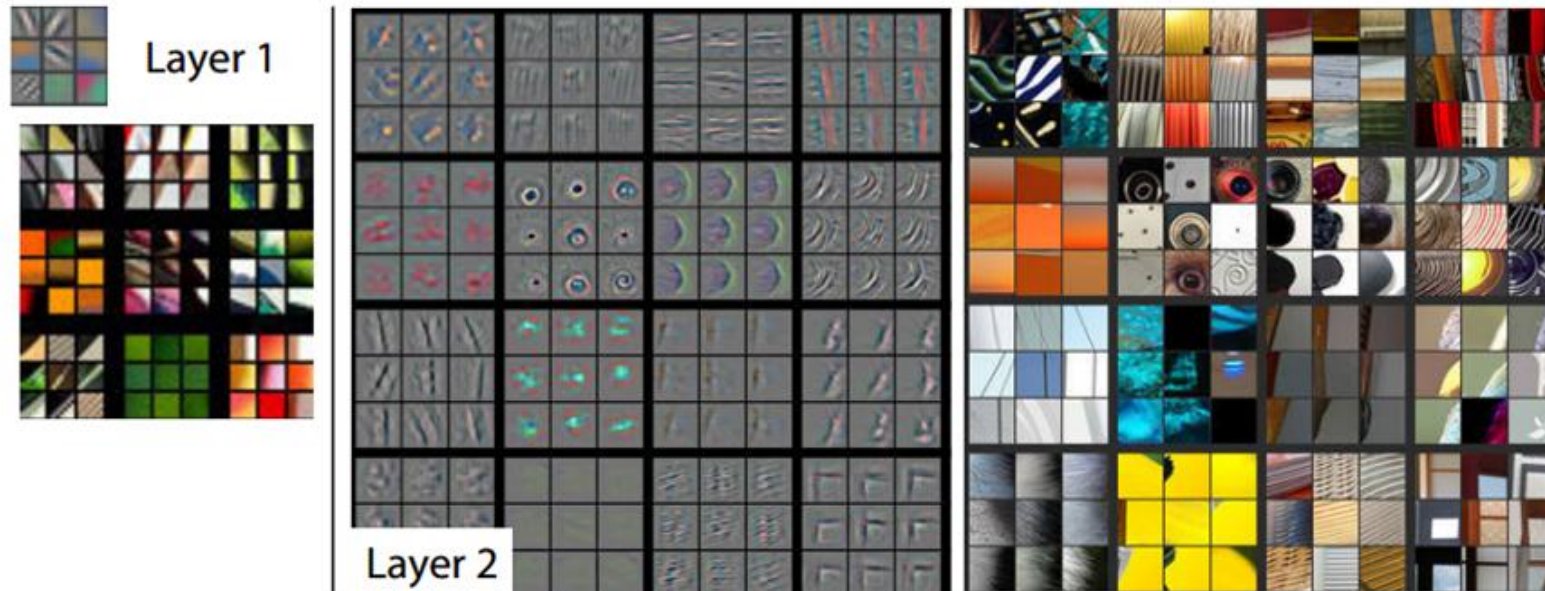
Automatic **hierarchical** feature extraction

Learning a **representation** (features) of the input

Filters are **learned** from data

Convolutional Neural Networks

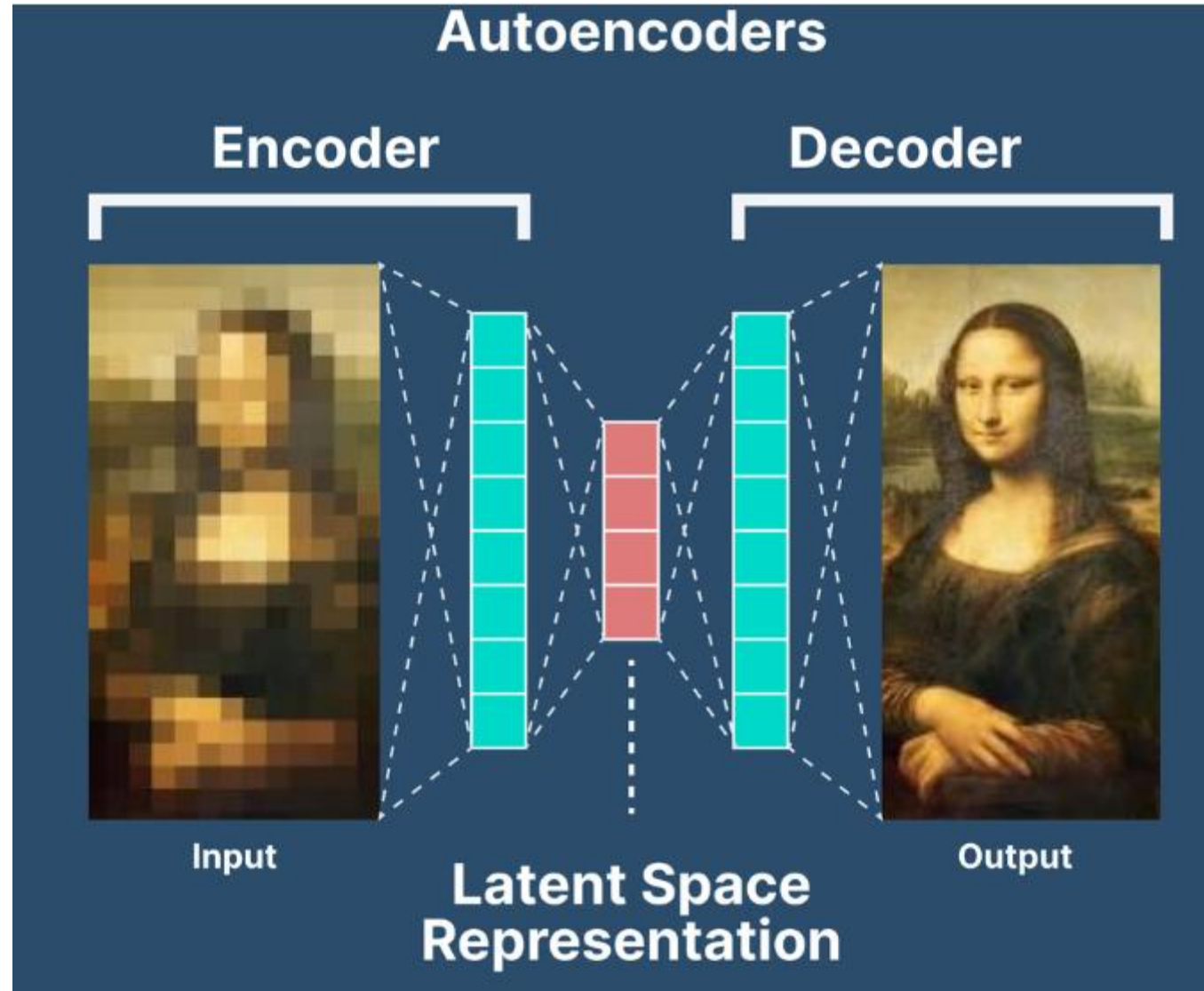
Examples of learned filters



Visualizations of Layer 1 and 2. Each layer illustrates 2 pictures, one which shows the filters themselves and one that shows what part of the image are most strongly activated by the given filter. For example, in the space labeled Layer 2, we have representations of the 16 different filters (on the left)

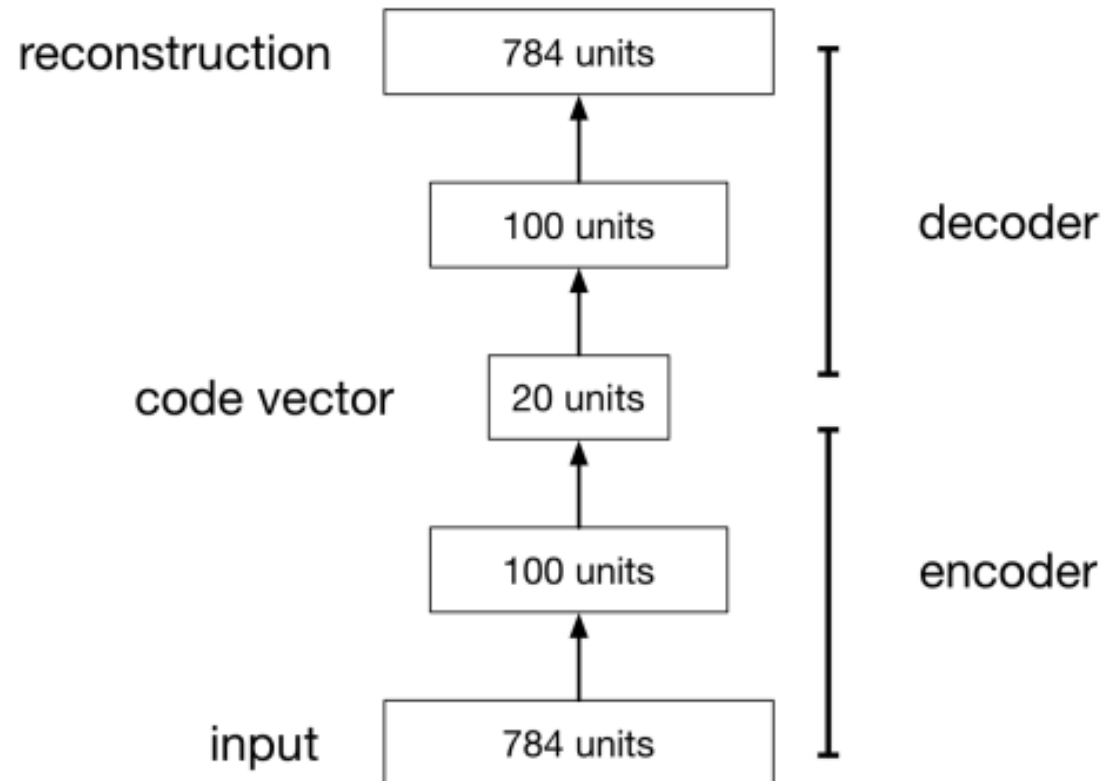
www.kdnuggets.com

Autoencoders



Autoencoders

- An **autoencoder** is a feed-forward neural net whose job it is to take an input $\mathbf{x}$ and predict $\mathbf{x}$.
- To make this non-trivial, we need to add a **bottleneck layer** whose dimension is much smaller than the input.



Autoencoders

Why autoencoders?

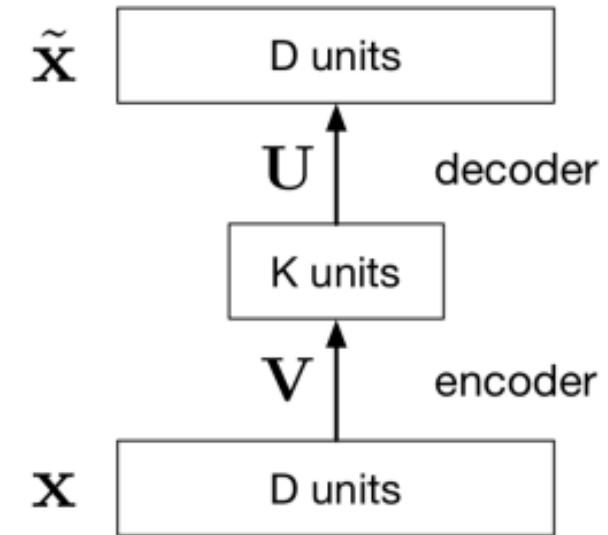
- Map high-dimensional data to two dimensions for visualization
- Compression (i.e. reducing the file size)
- Learn abstract features in an unsupervised way so you can apply them to a supervised task
 - Unlabeled data can be much more plentiful than labeled data

Principal Component Analysis

- The simplest kind of autoencoder has one hidden layer, linear activations, and squared error loss.

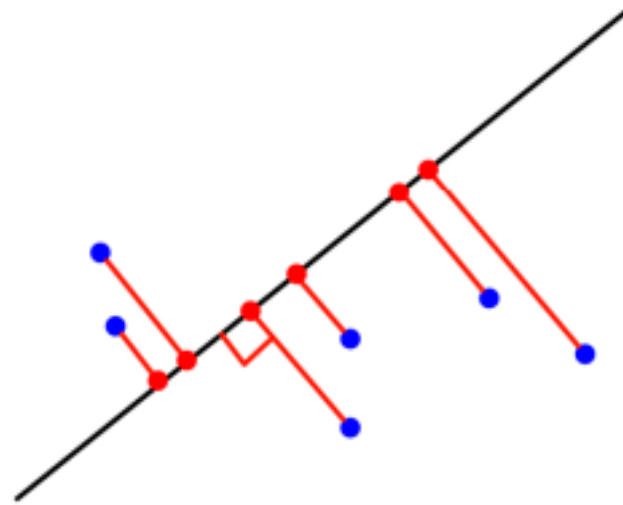
$$\mathcal{L}(\mathbf{x}, \tilde{\mathbf{x}}) = \|\mathbf{x} - \tilde{\mathbf{x}}\|^2$$

- This network computes $\tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{U}\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x}$, which is a linear function.
- If $K \geq D$, we can choose $\mathbf{U}$ and $\mathbf{V}$ such that $\mathbf{U}\mathbf{V}$ is the identity. This isn't very interesting.
- But suppose $K < D$:
 - $\mathbf{V}$ maps $\mathbf{x}$ to a K -dimensional space, so it's doing dimensionality reduction.
 - The output must lie in a K -dimensional subspace, namely the column space of $\mathbf{U}$.



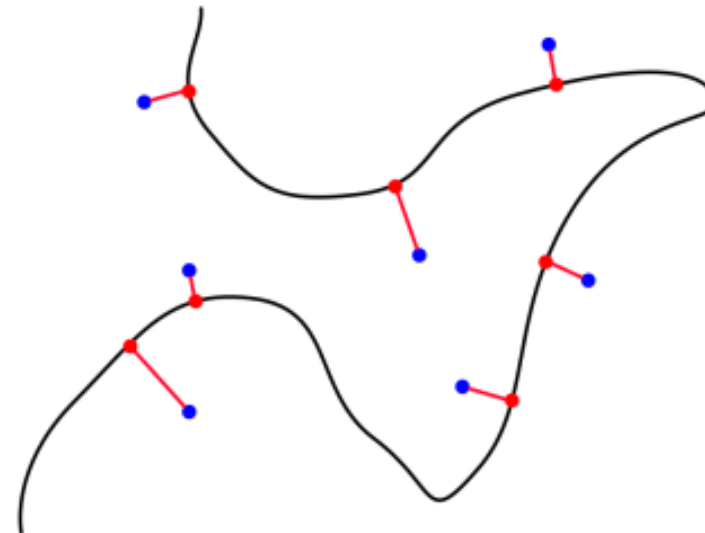
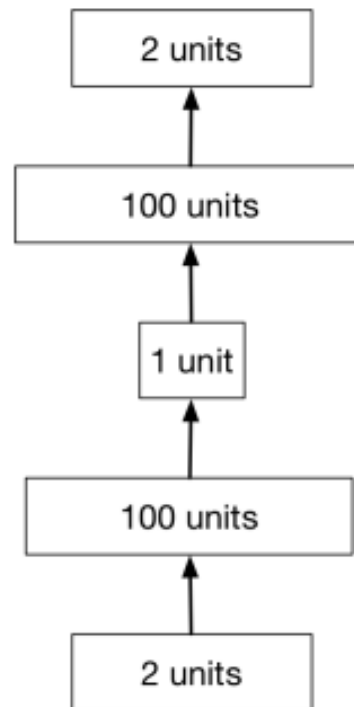
Principal Component Analysis

- We just saw that a linear autoencoder has to map D -dimensional inputs to a K -dimensional subspace $\mathcal{S}$.
- Knowing this, what is the best possible mapping it can choose?
 - By definition, the **projection** of $\mathbf{x}$ onto $\mathcal{S}$ is the point in $\mathcal{S}$ which minimizes the distance to $\mathbf{x}$.

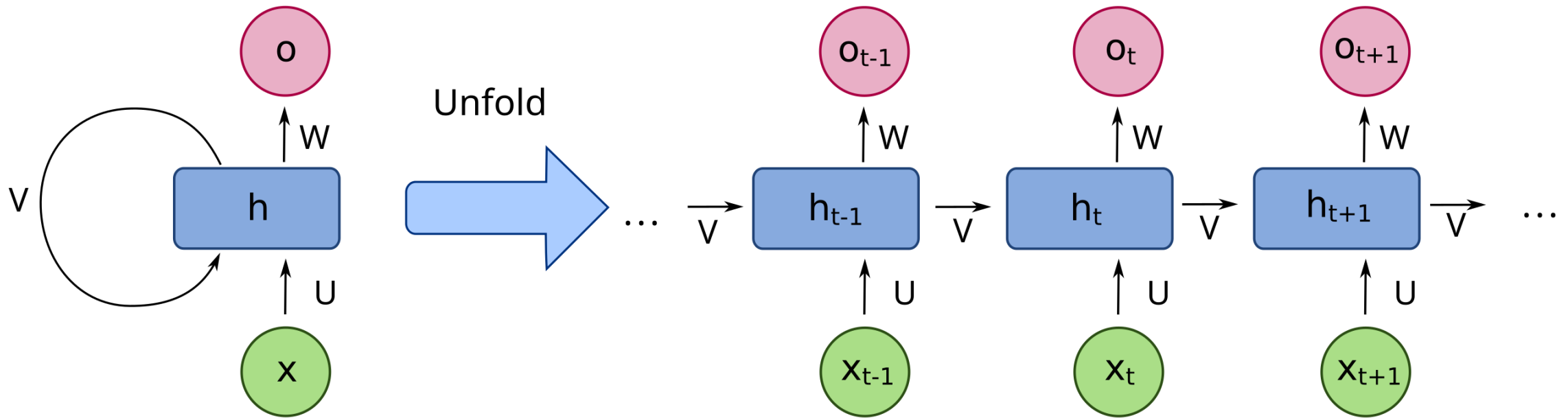


Deep Autoencoders

- Deep nonlinear autoencoders learn to project the data, not c subspace, but onto a nonlinear **manifold**
- This manifold is the image of the decoder.
- This is a kind of **nonlinear dimensionality reduction**.

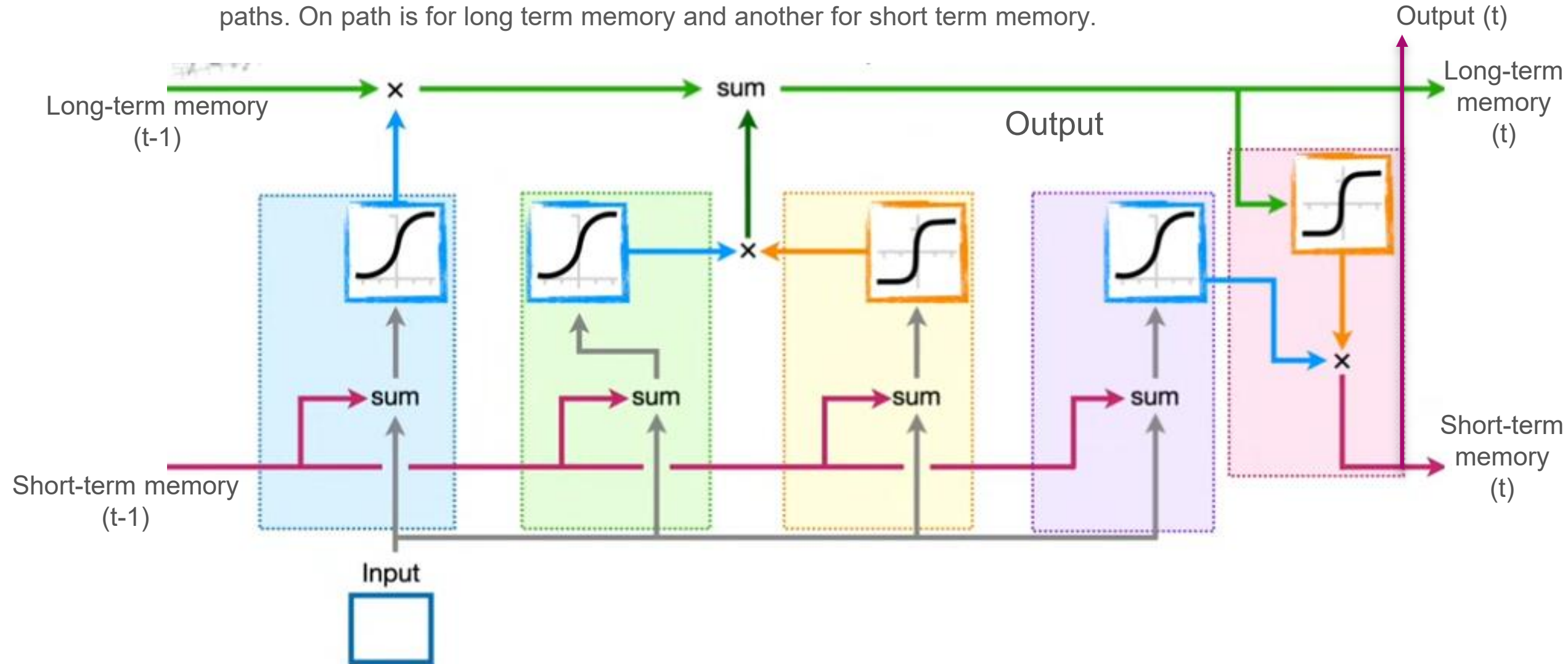


RNN – See Notebook



LSTM – Long Short Term Memory

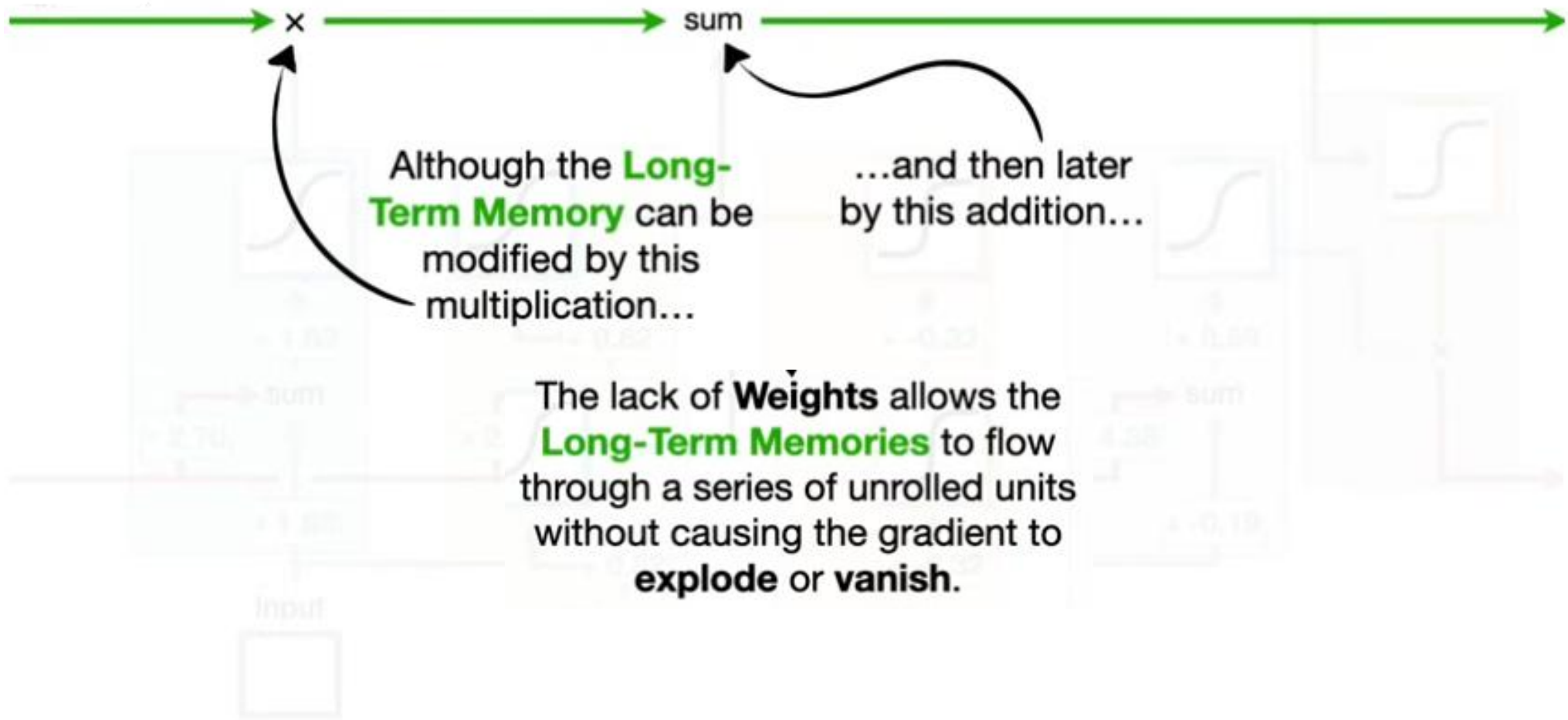
- Main idea:** instead of using the same feedback loop connection for events (data) that happened long ago and events (data) that happened yesterday (e.g., previous time stamp), LSTM uses two distinct paths. One path is for long term memory and another for short term memory.



Long Short-Term Memory uses **Sigmoid Activation Functions...**

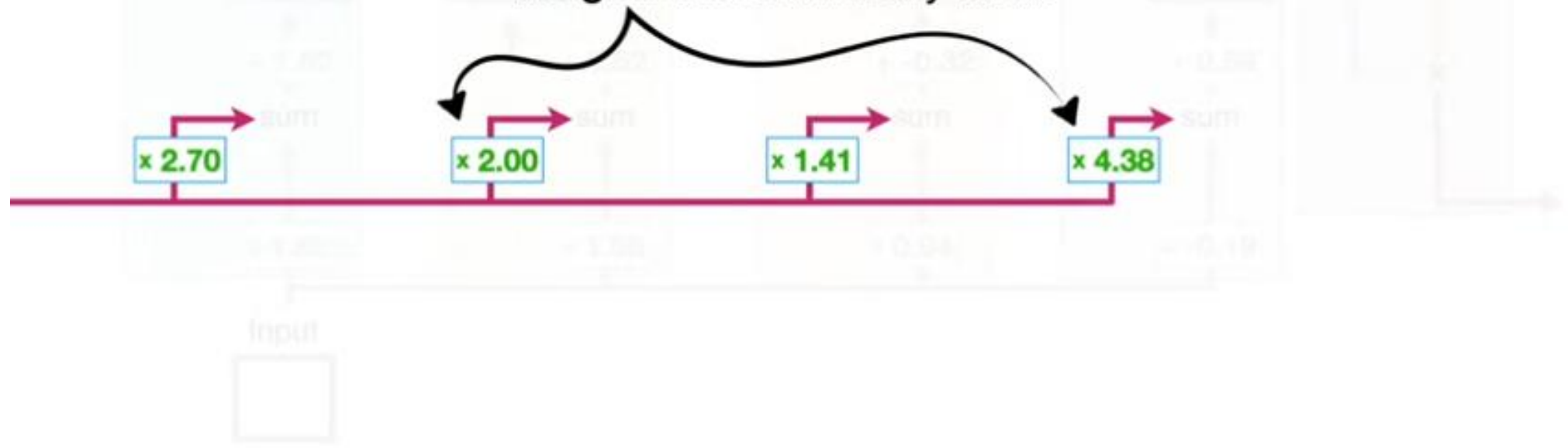


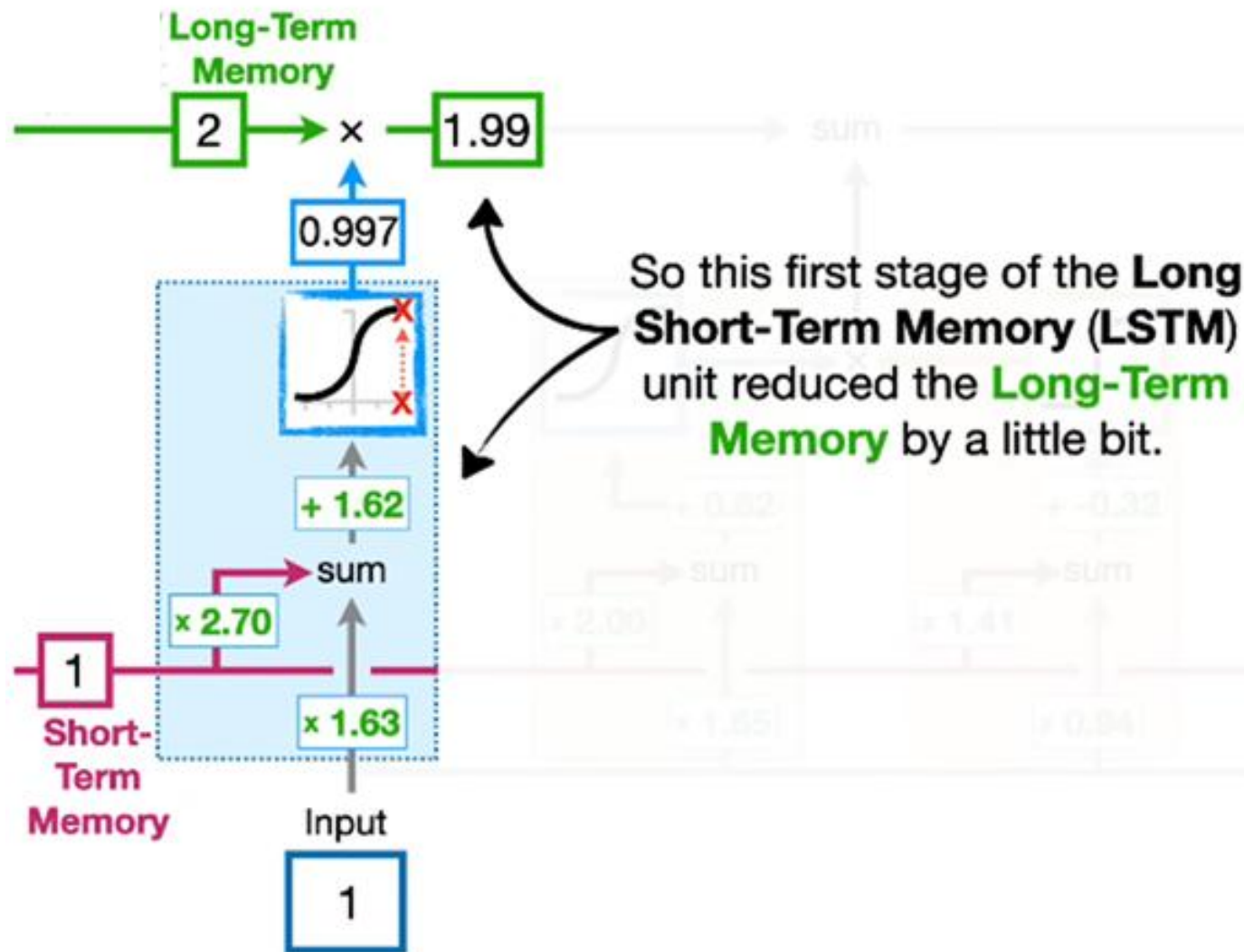
...and **Tanh Activation Functions...**

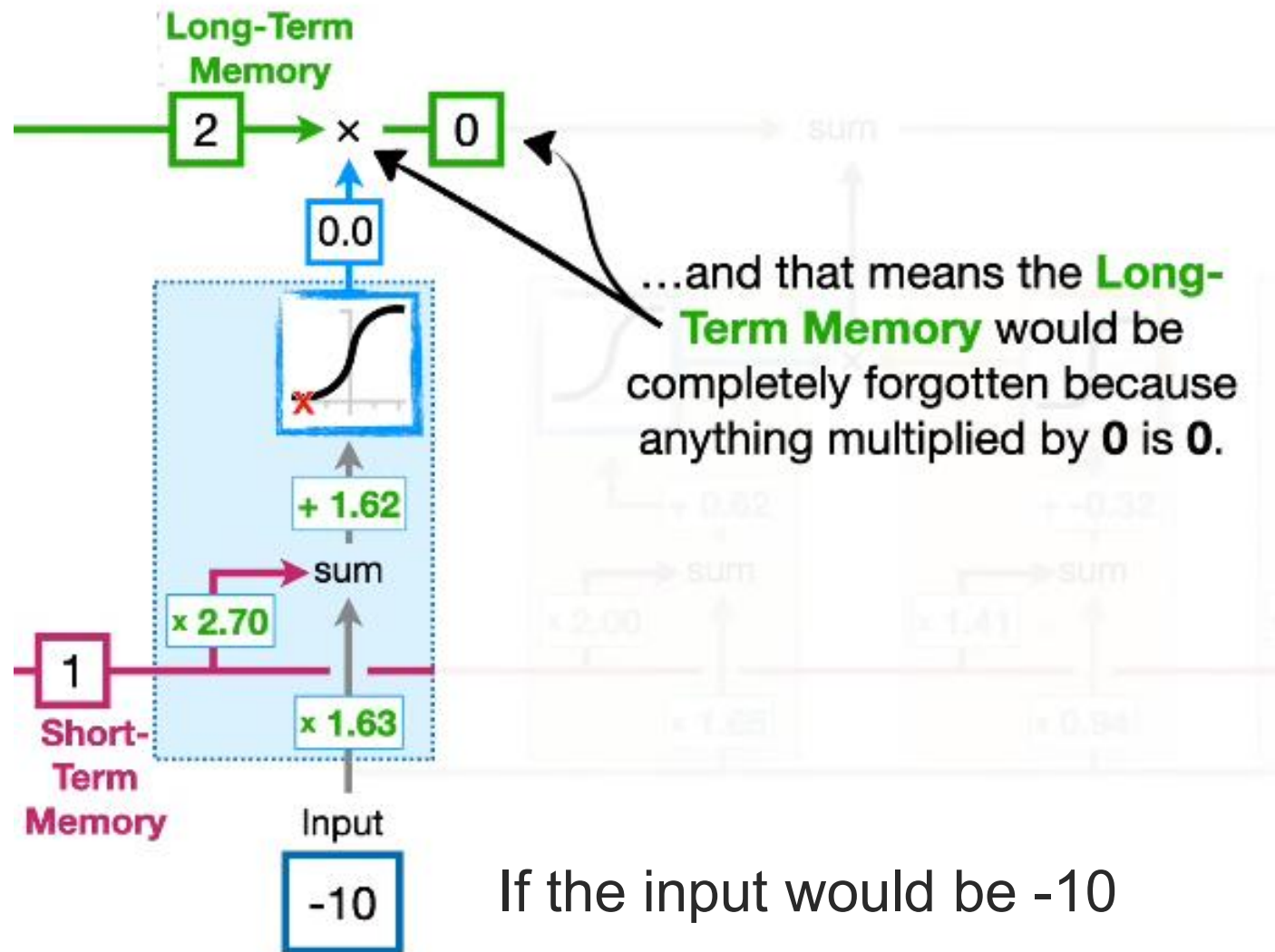




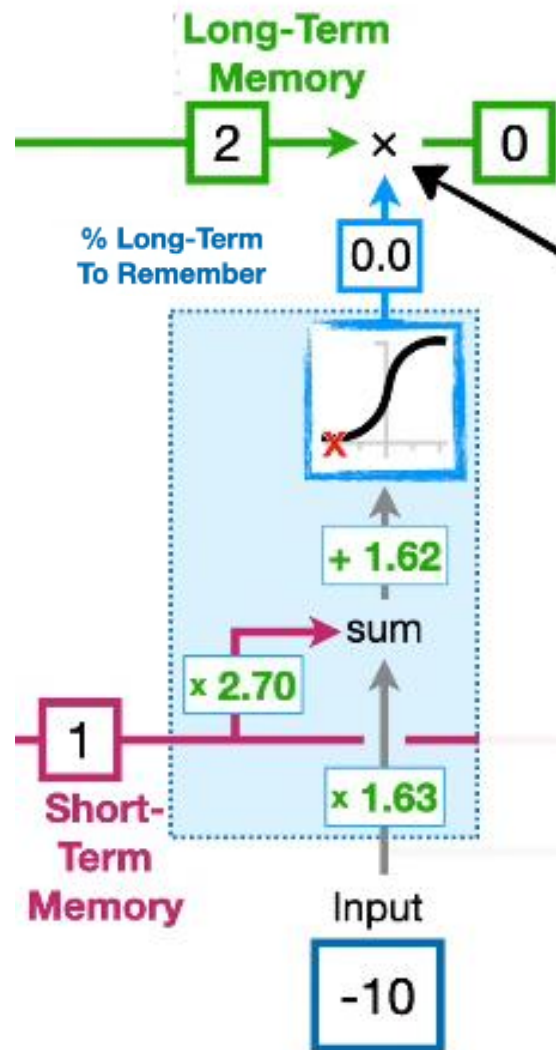
And, as we can see, the **Short-Term Memories** are directly connected to **Weights** that can modify them.







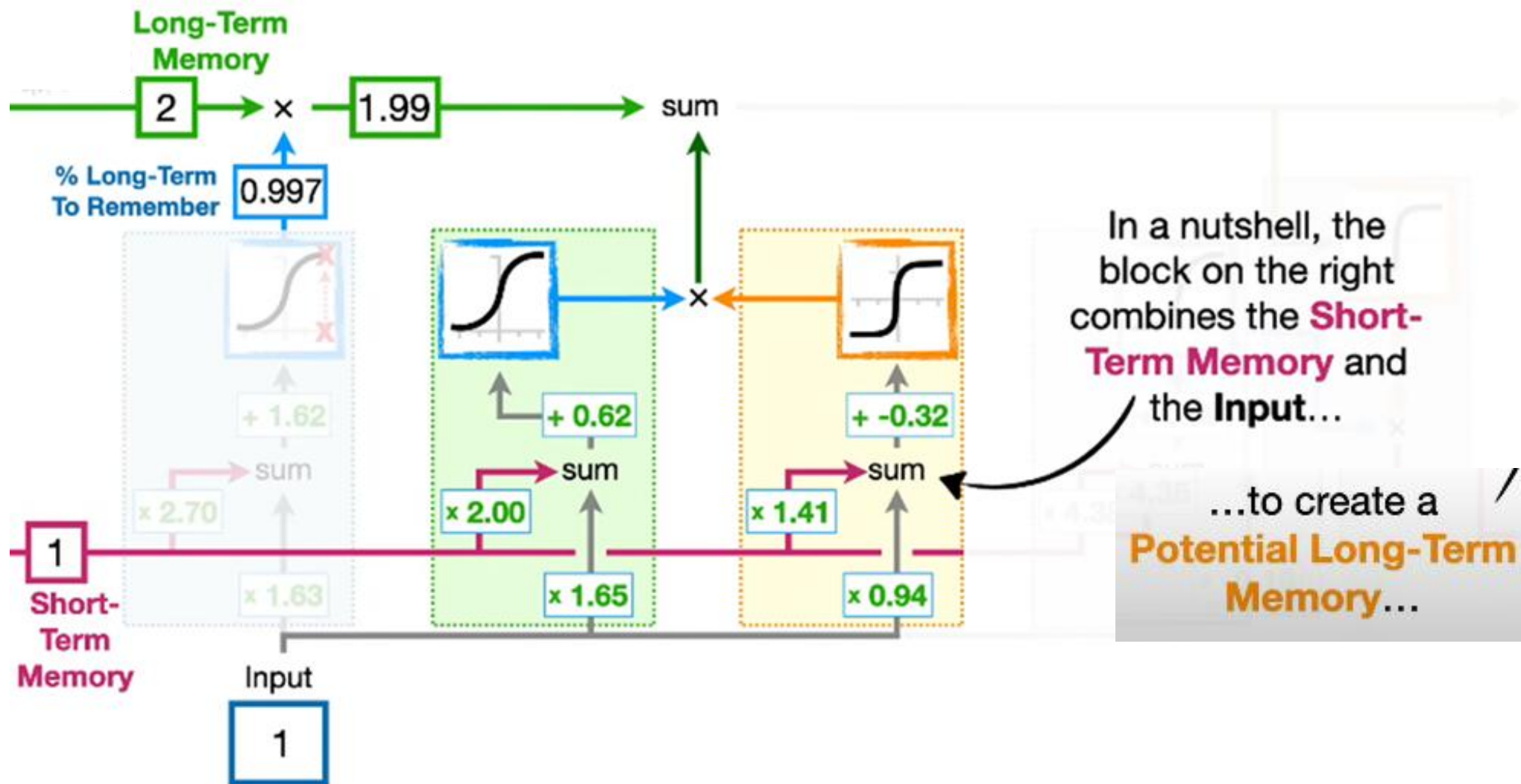
If the input would be -10

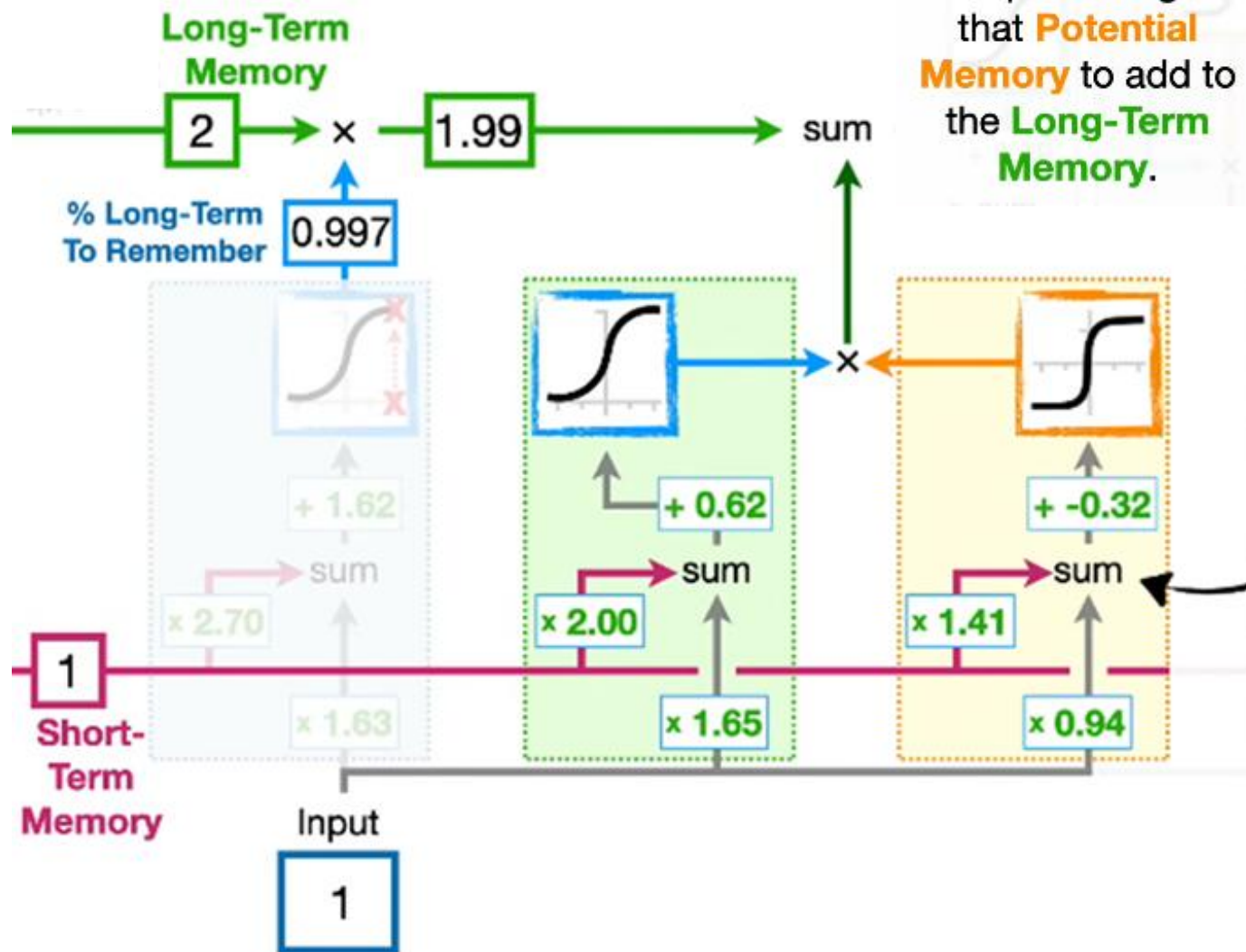


...and that means the **Long-Term Memory** would be completely forgotten because anything multiplied by **0** is **0**.

To summarize, the first stage in a **Long Short-Term Memory** unit determines what percentage of the **Long-Term Memory** is remembered.

Therefore, this part is called the **Forget gate**

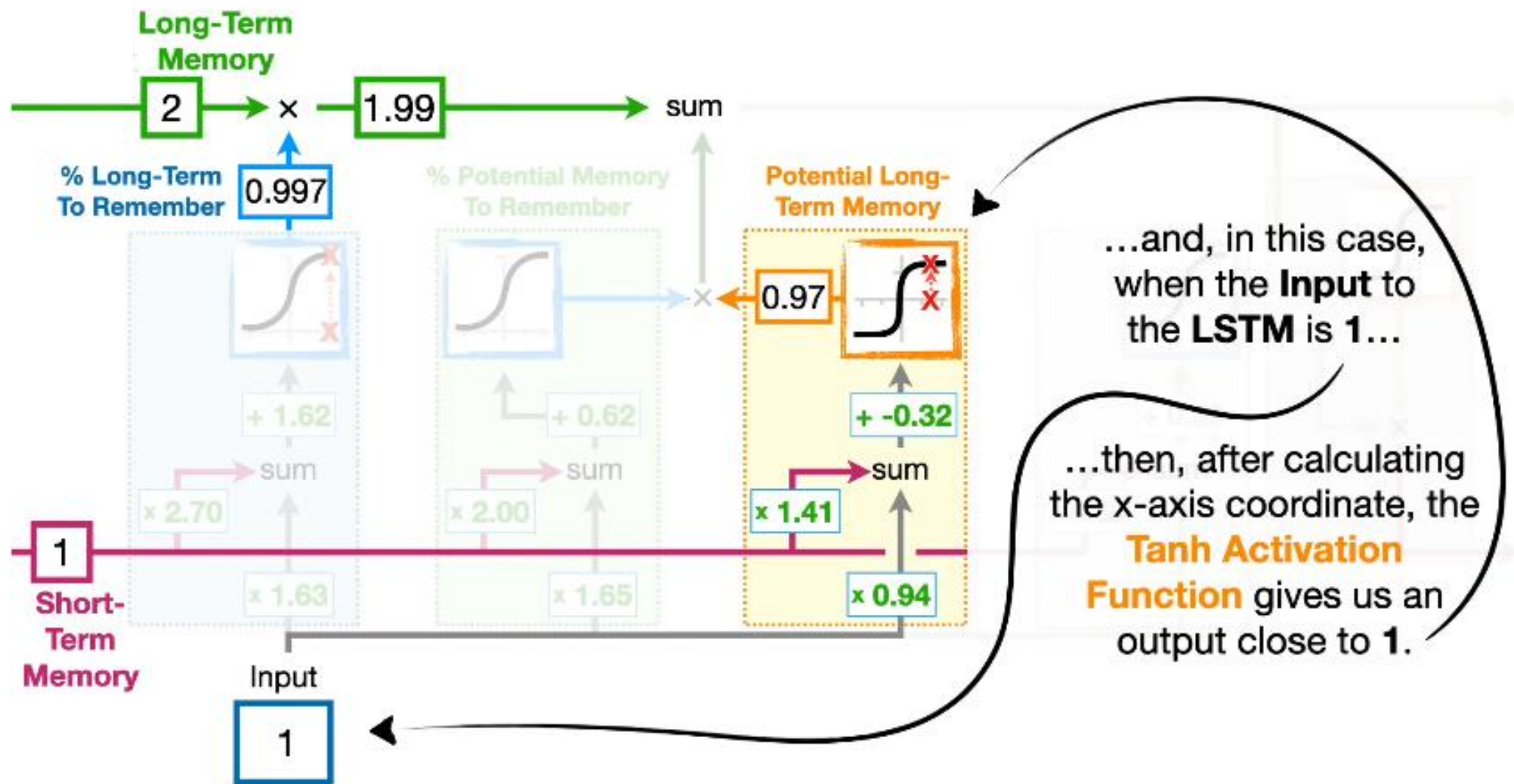


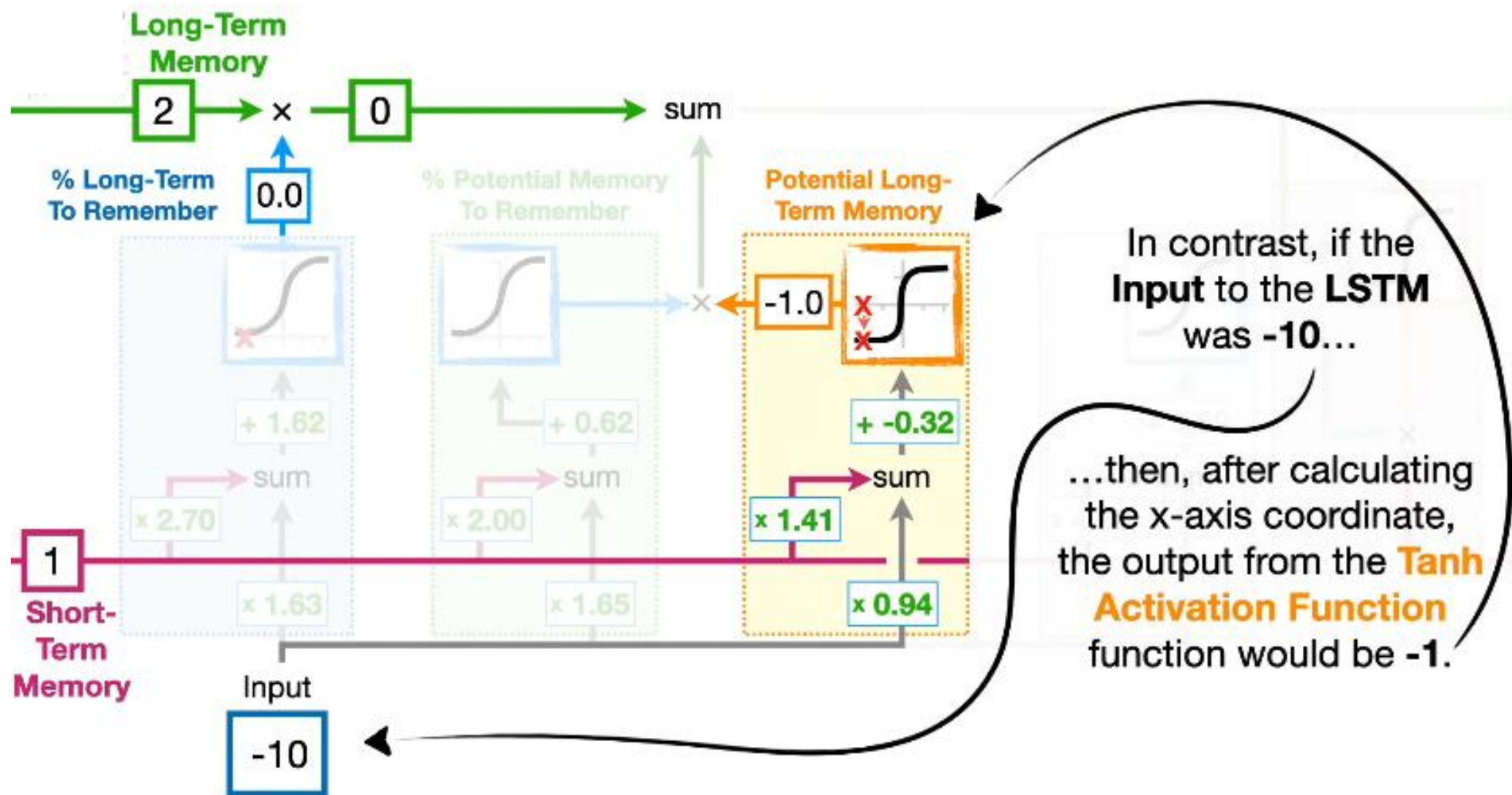


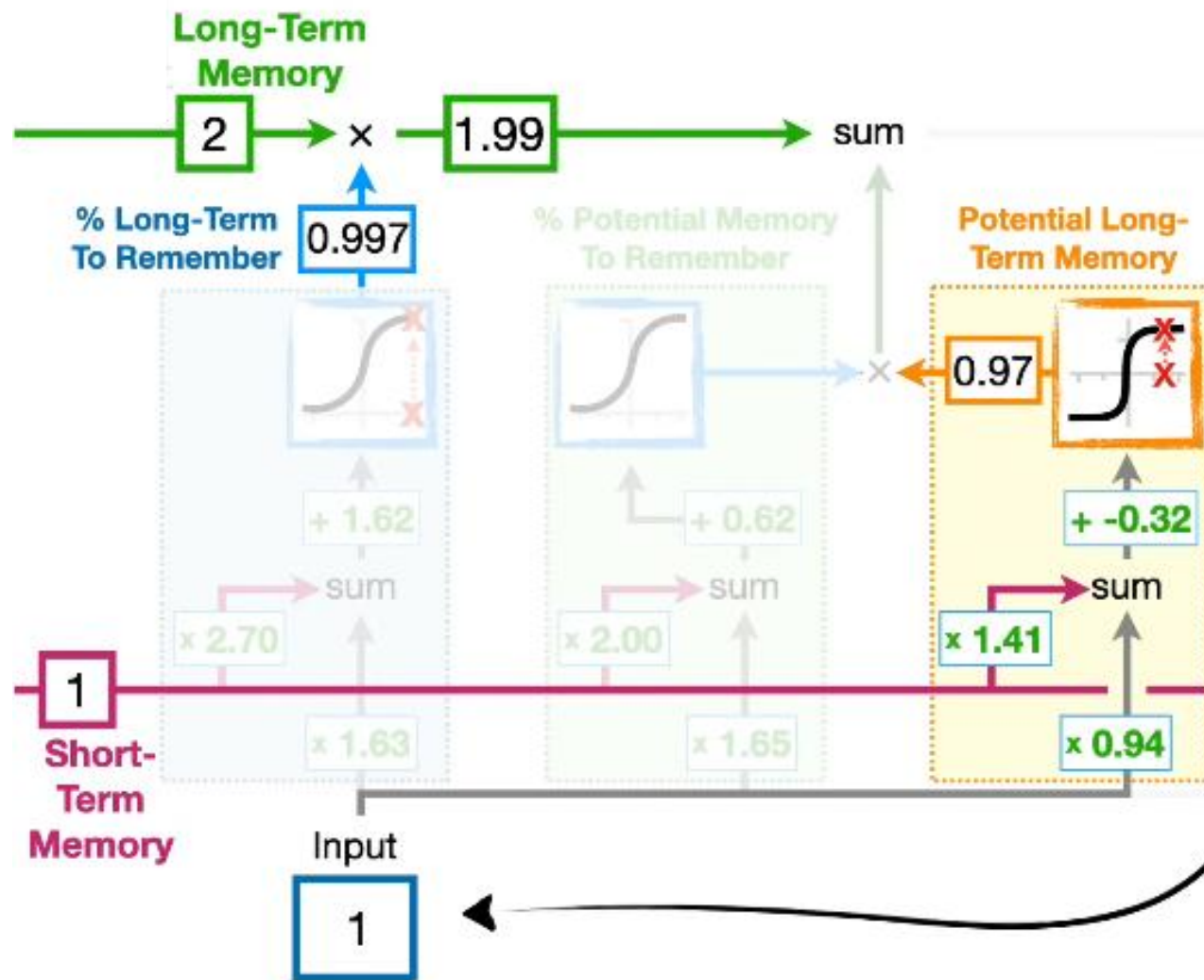
...and the block on the left determines what percentage of that **Potential Memory** to add to the **Long-Term Memory**.

In a nutshell, the block on the right combines the **Short-Term Memory** and the **Input**...

...to create a **Potential Long-Term Memory**...

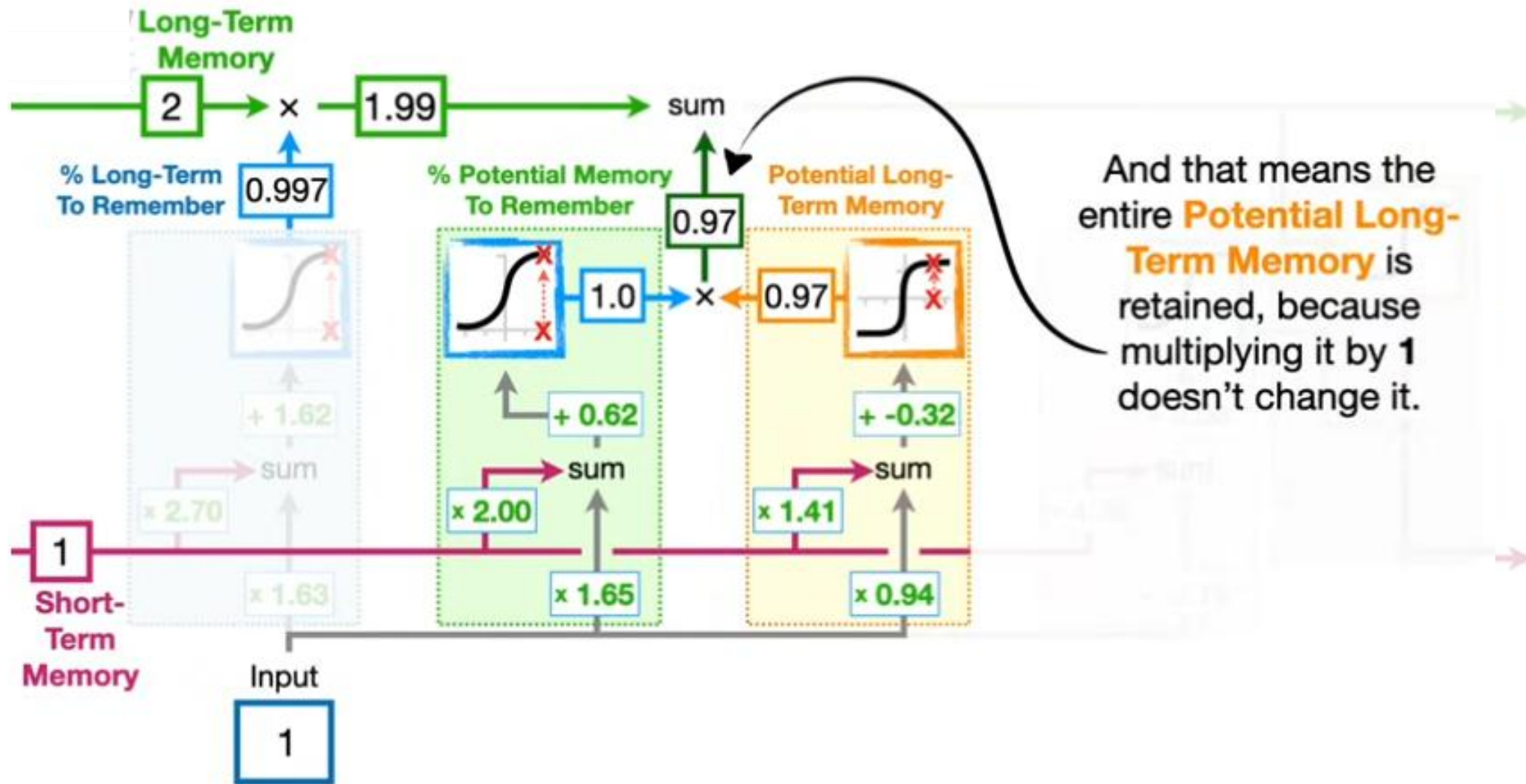


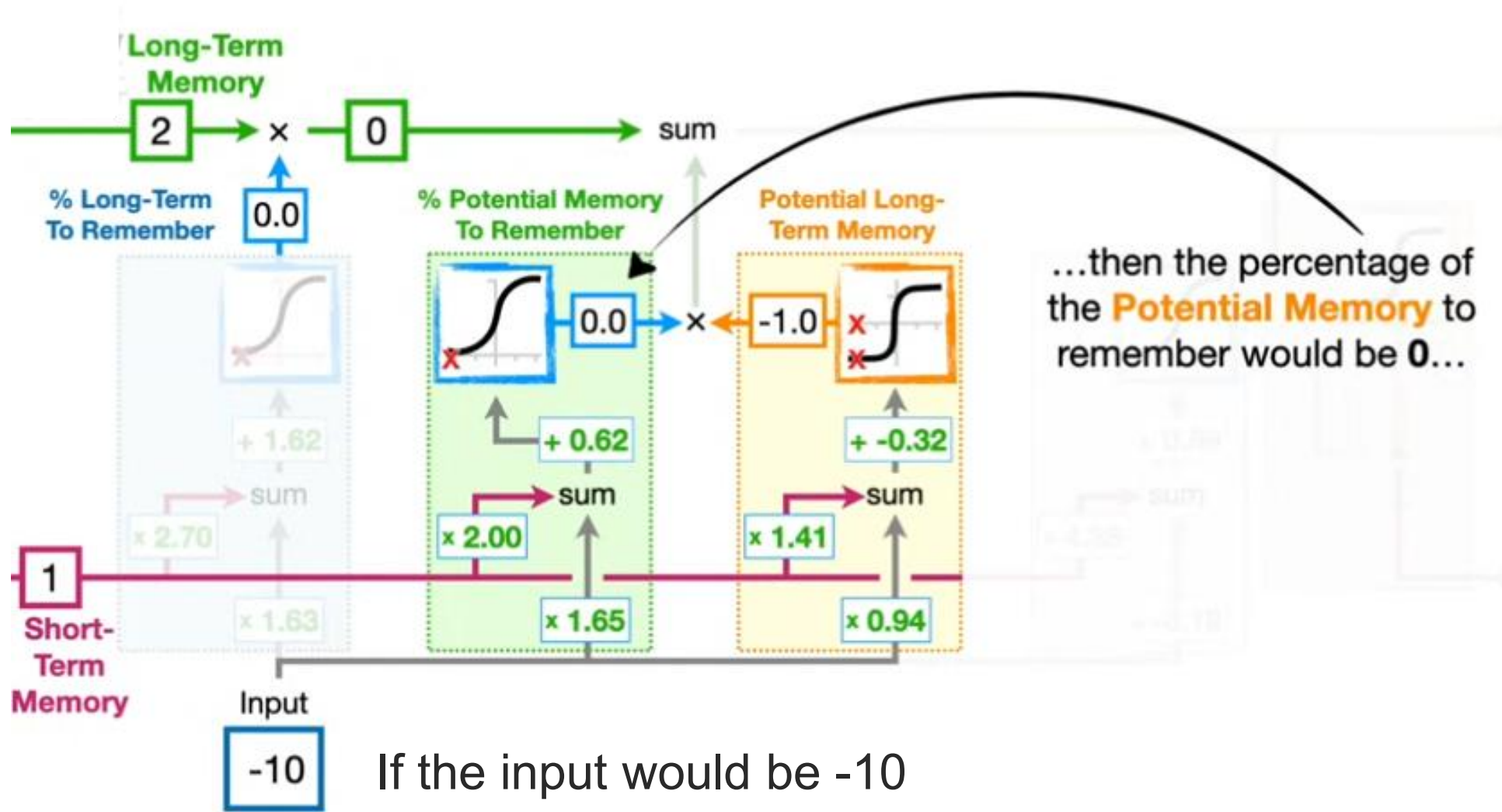




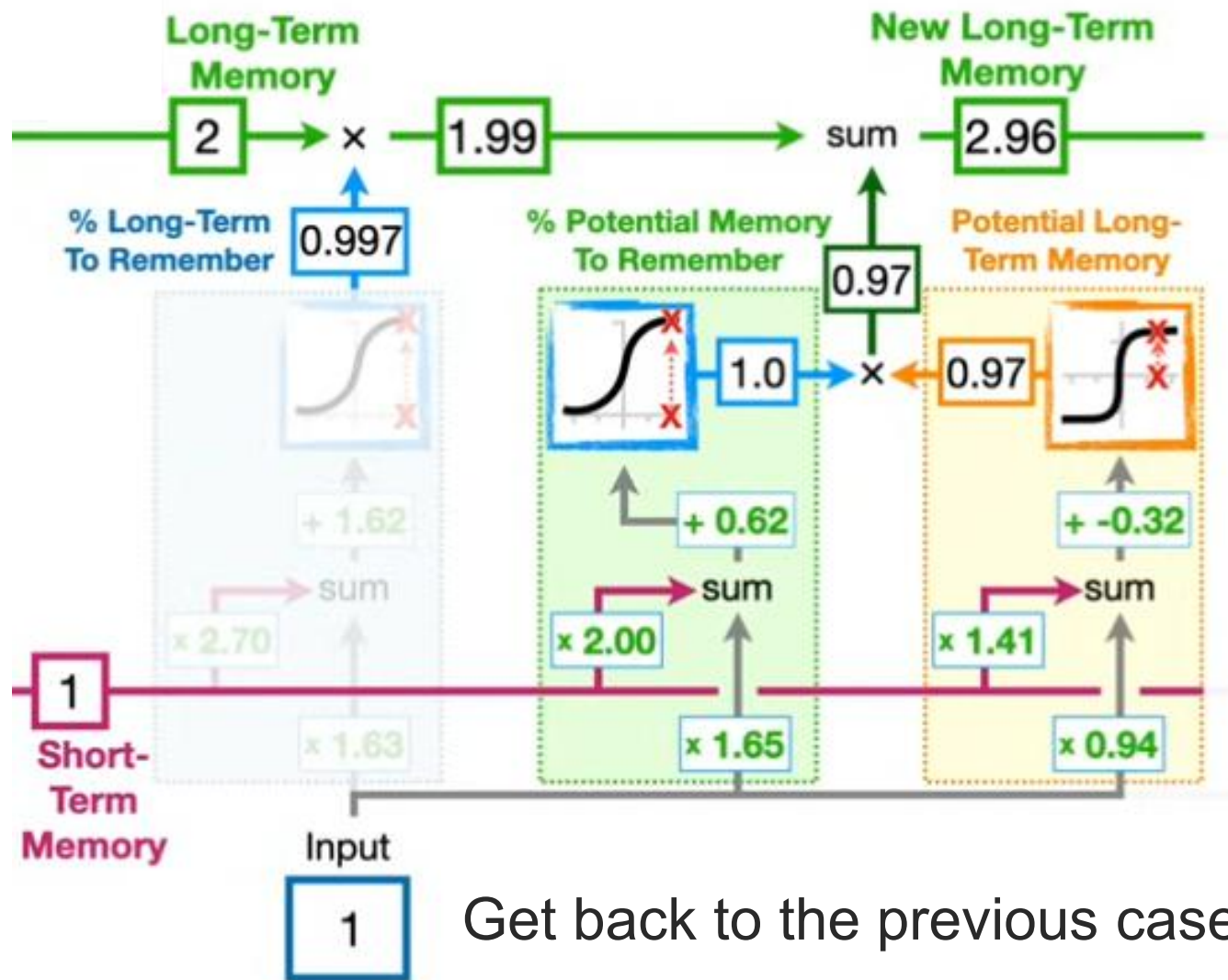
Get back to the previous case

Now the **LSTM** has to decide how much of this **Potential Memory** to save...





If the input would be -10



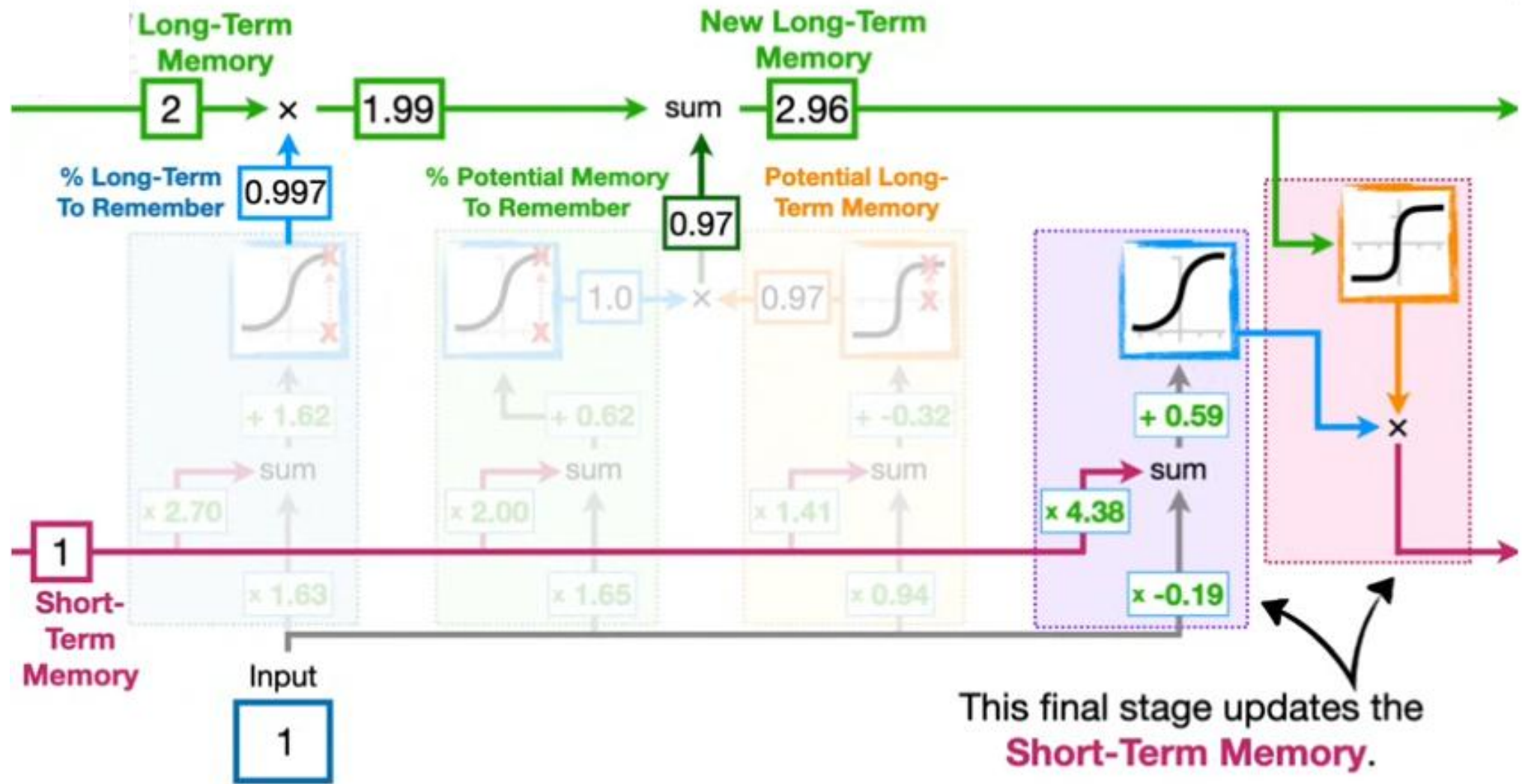
Get back to the previous case

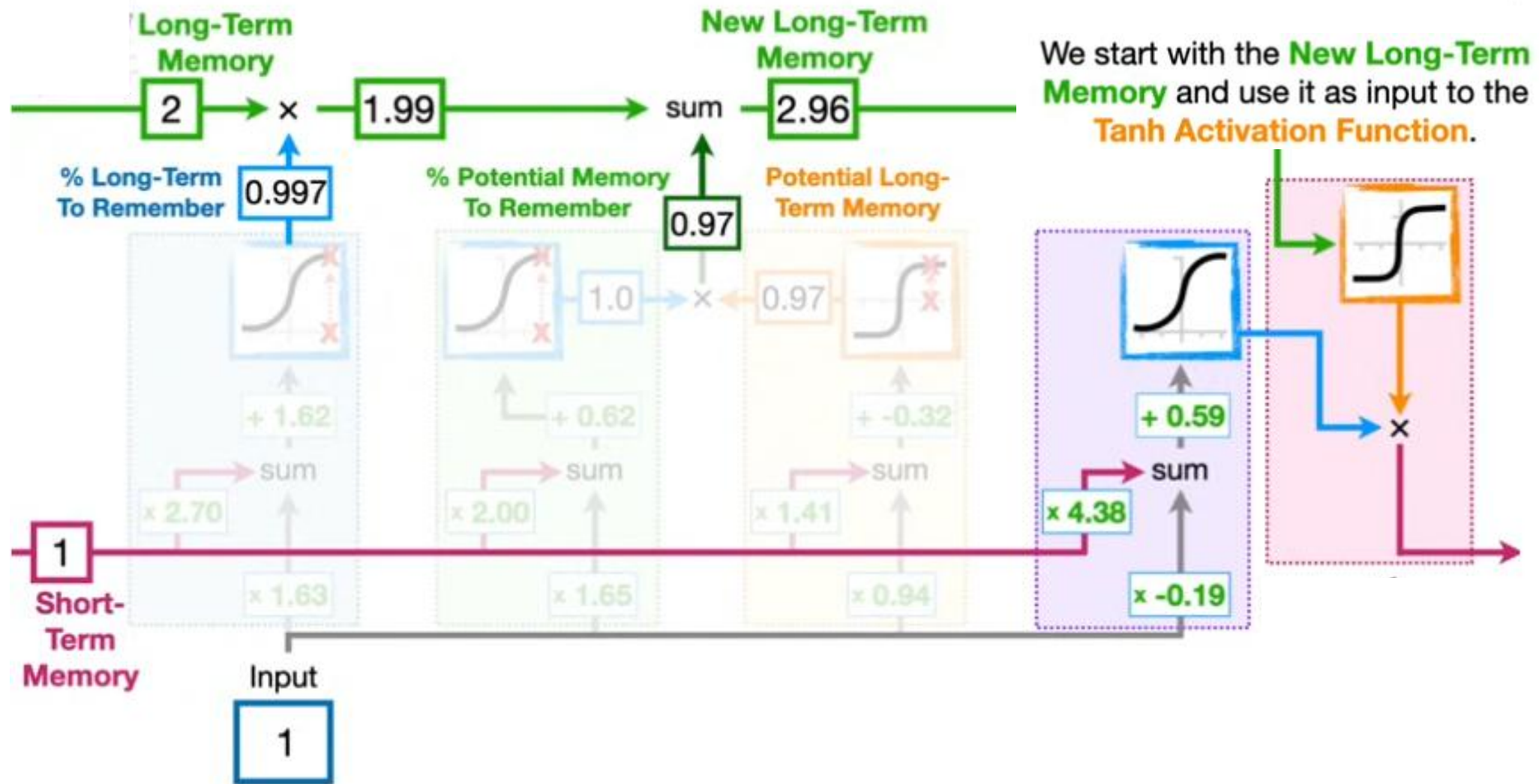
...we add **0.97** to the existing **Long-Term Memory**...

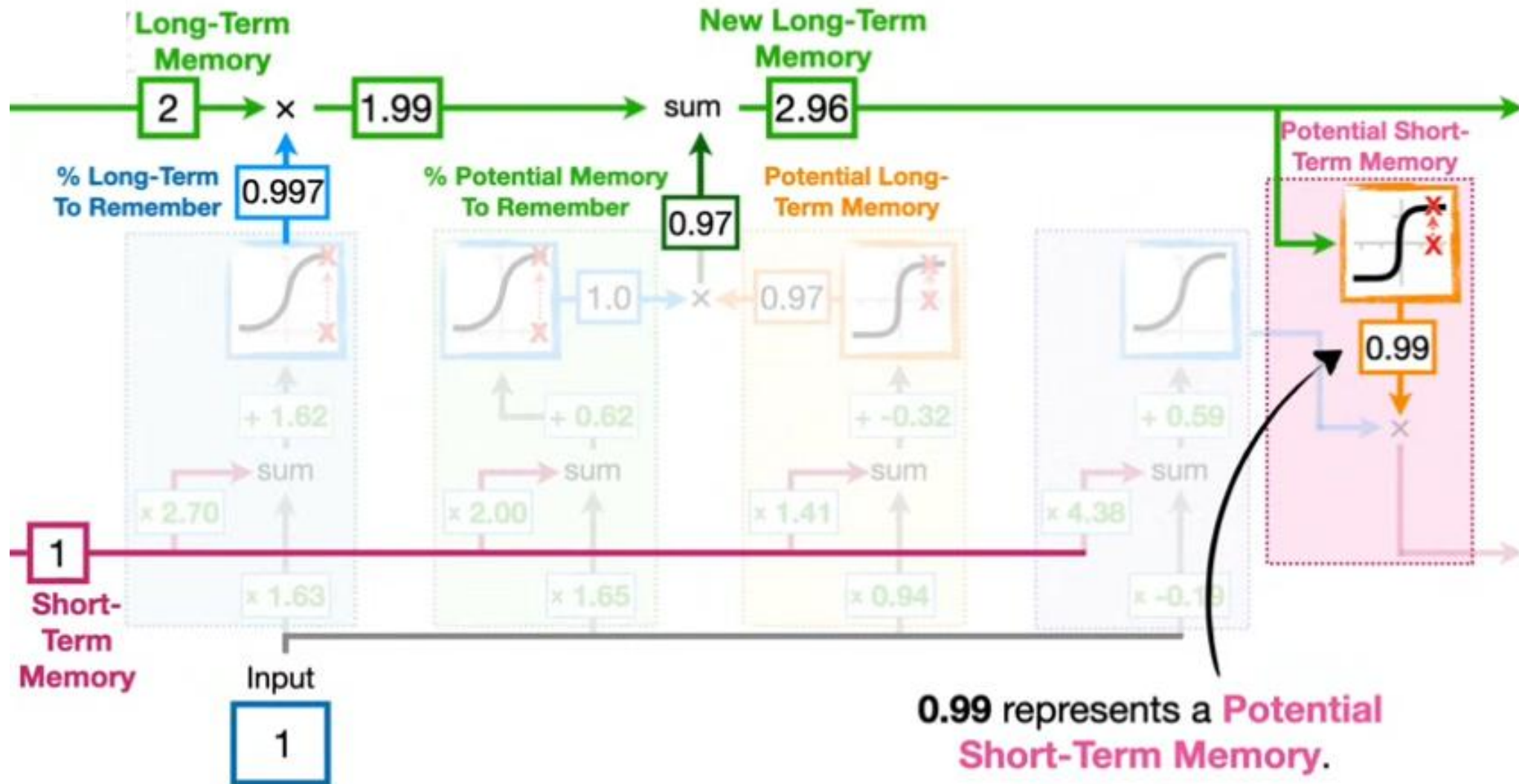
...and we get a new **Long-Term Memory**, **2.96**.

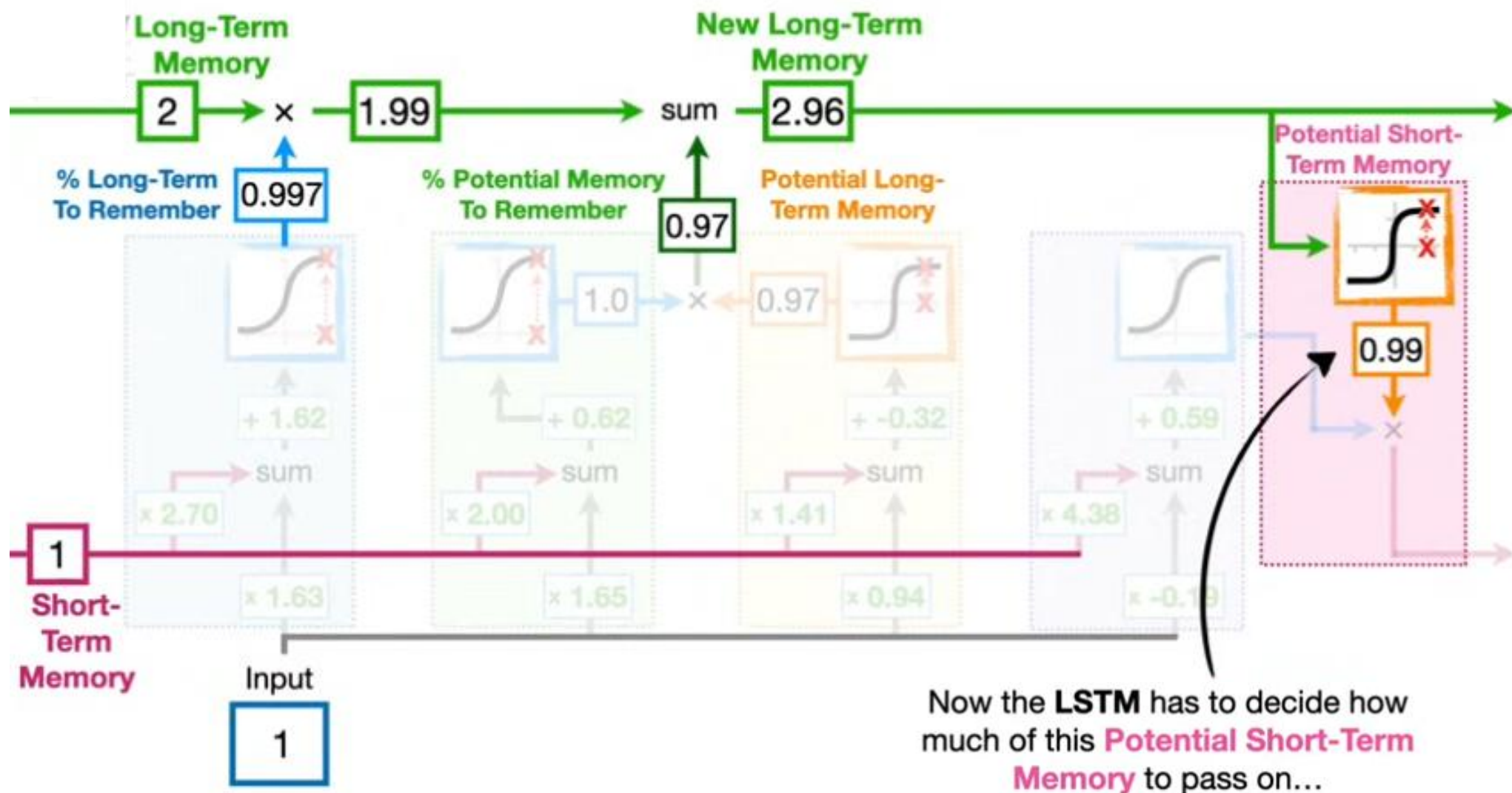
Even though this part of the **Long Short-Term Memory** unit determines how we should update the **Long-Term Memory**...

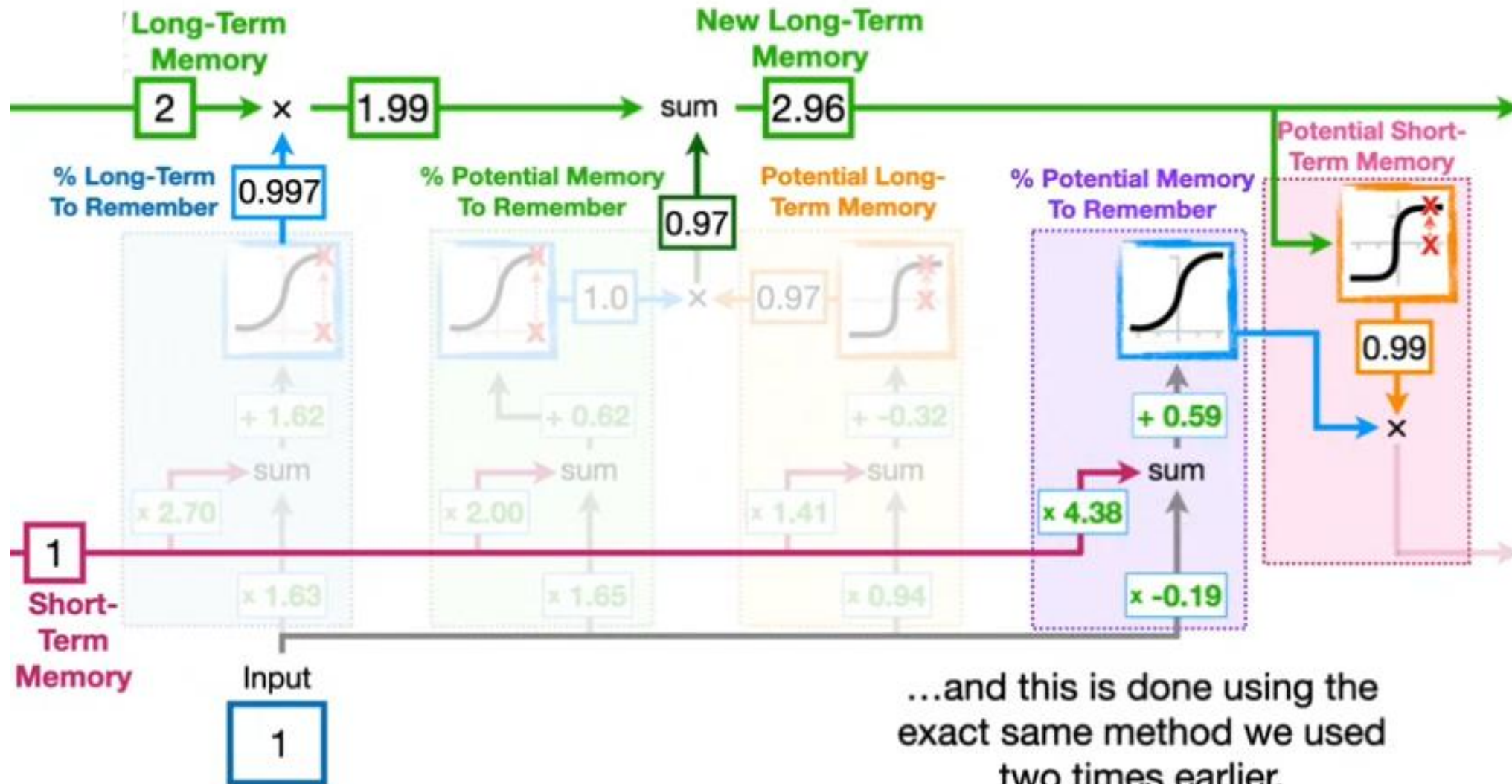
...it is usually called the **Input Gate**.



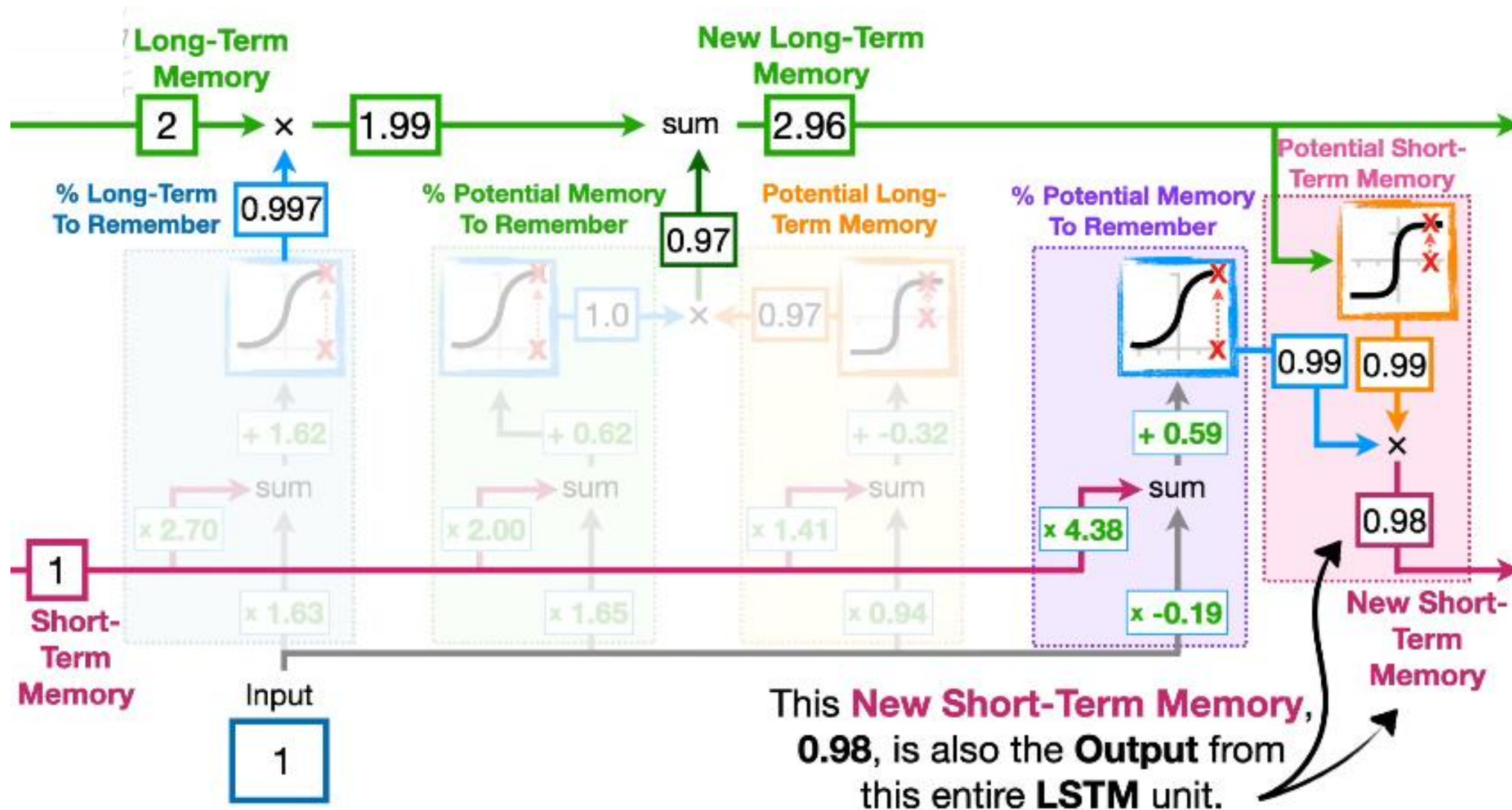






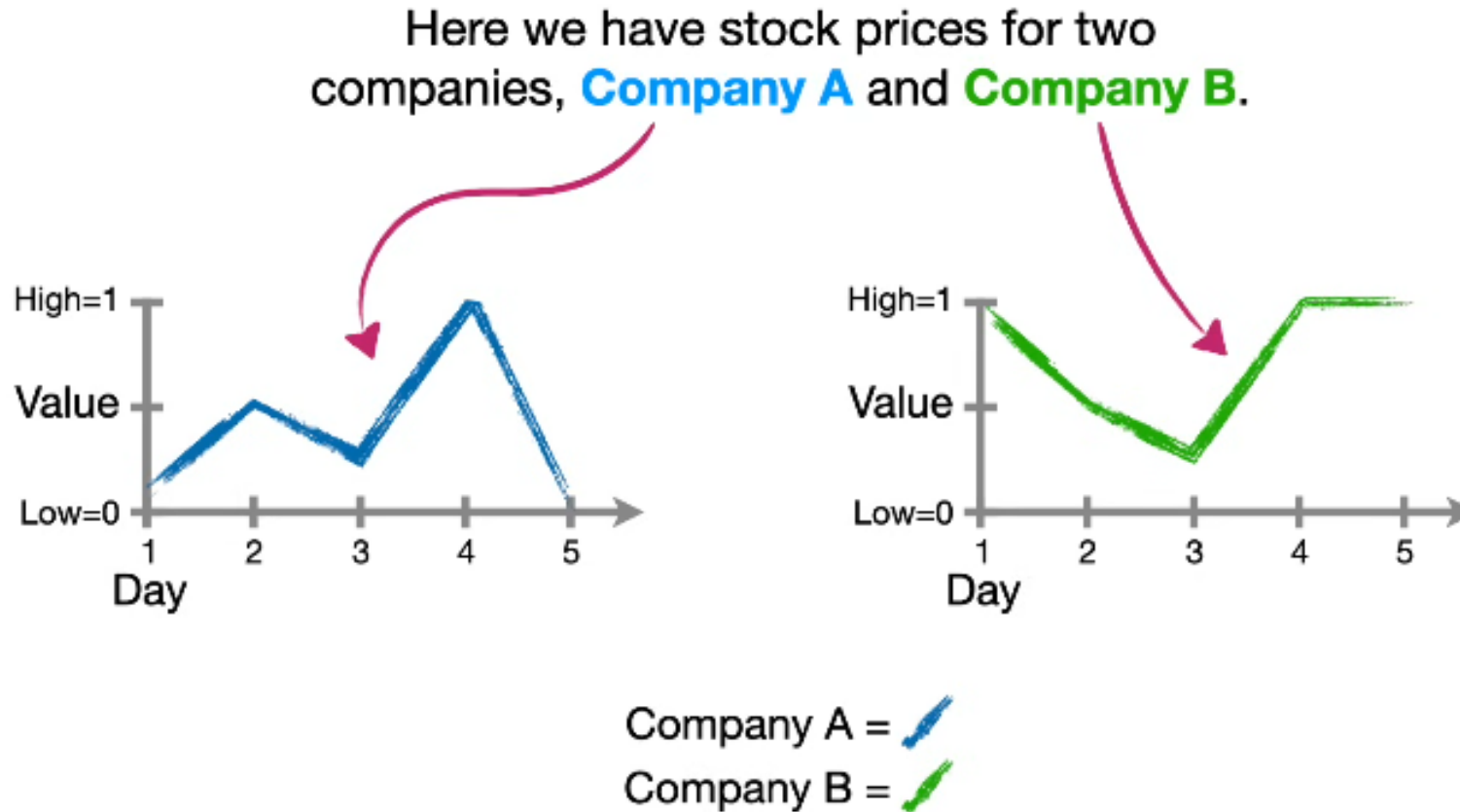


...and this is done using the exact same method we used two times earlier.

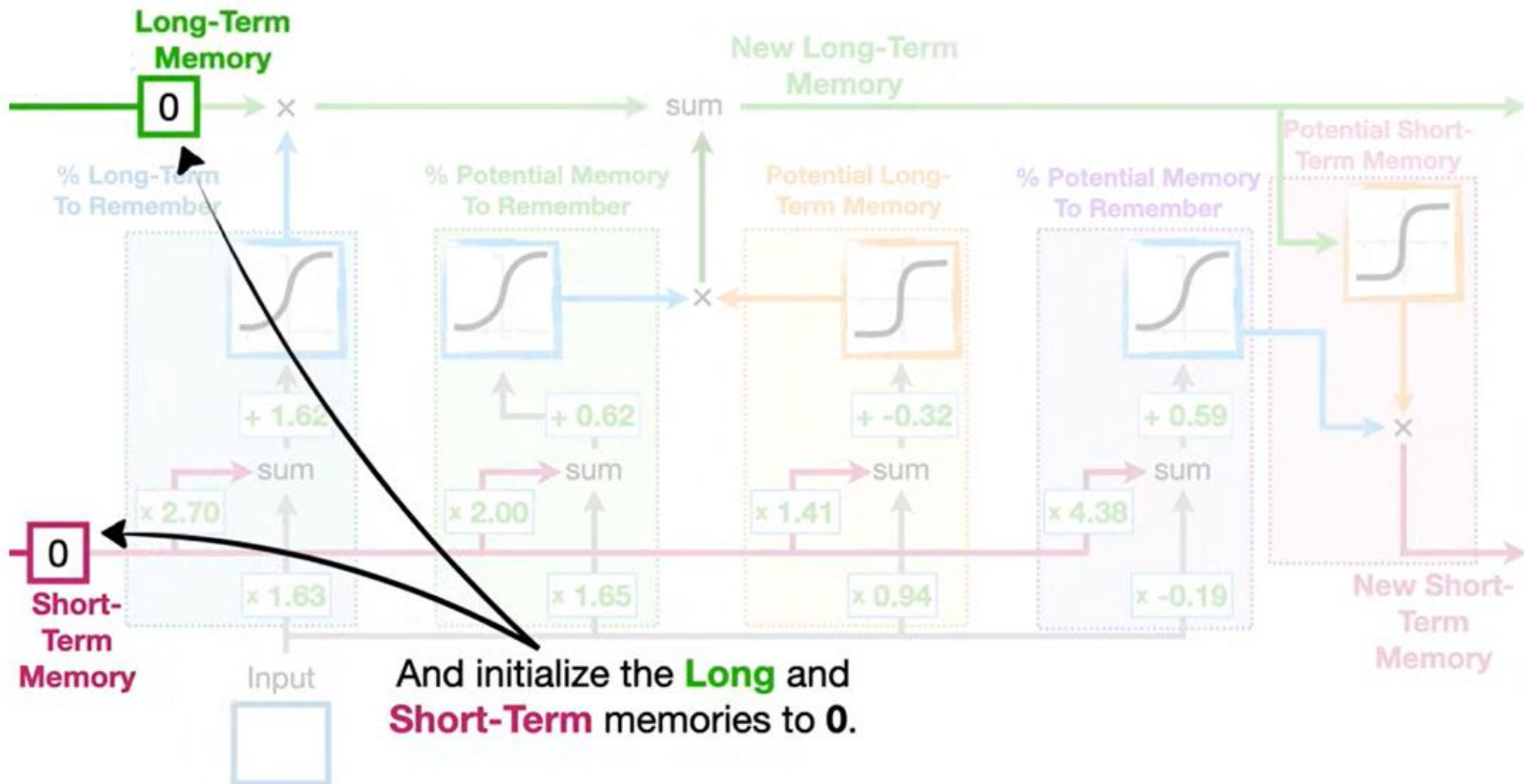


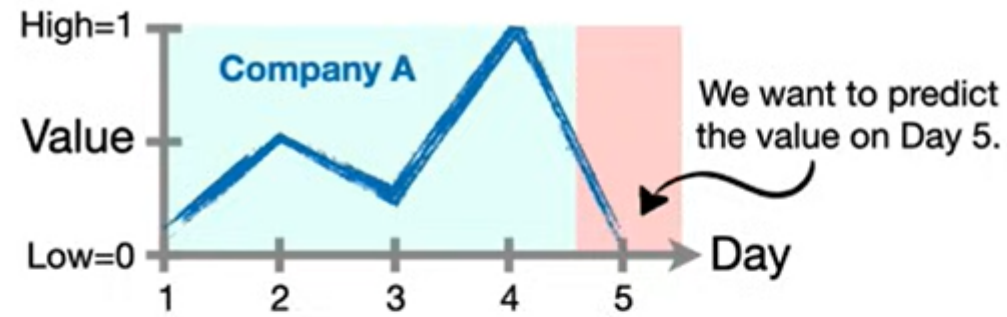
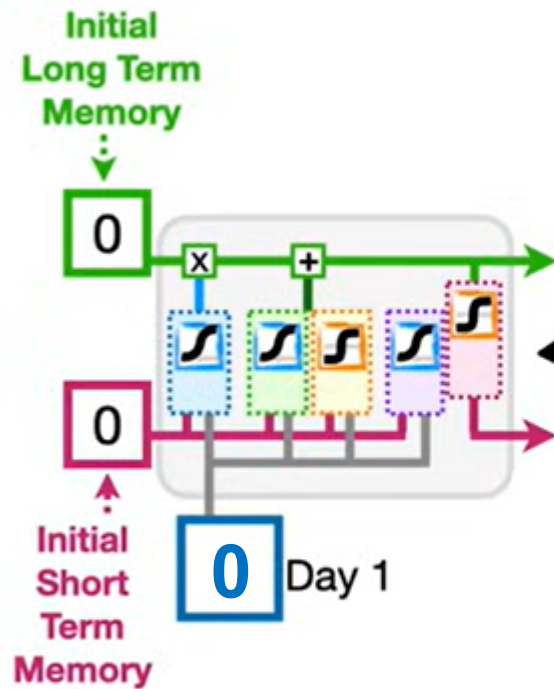
This part is called the **Output gate**

Let's see an example

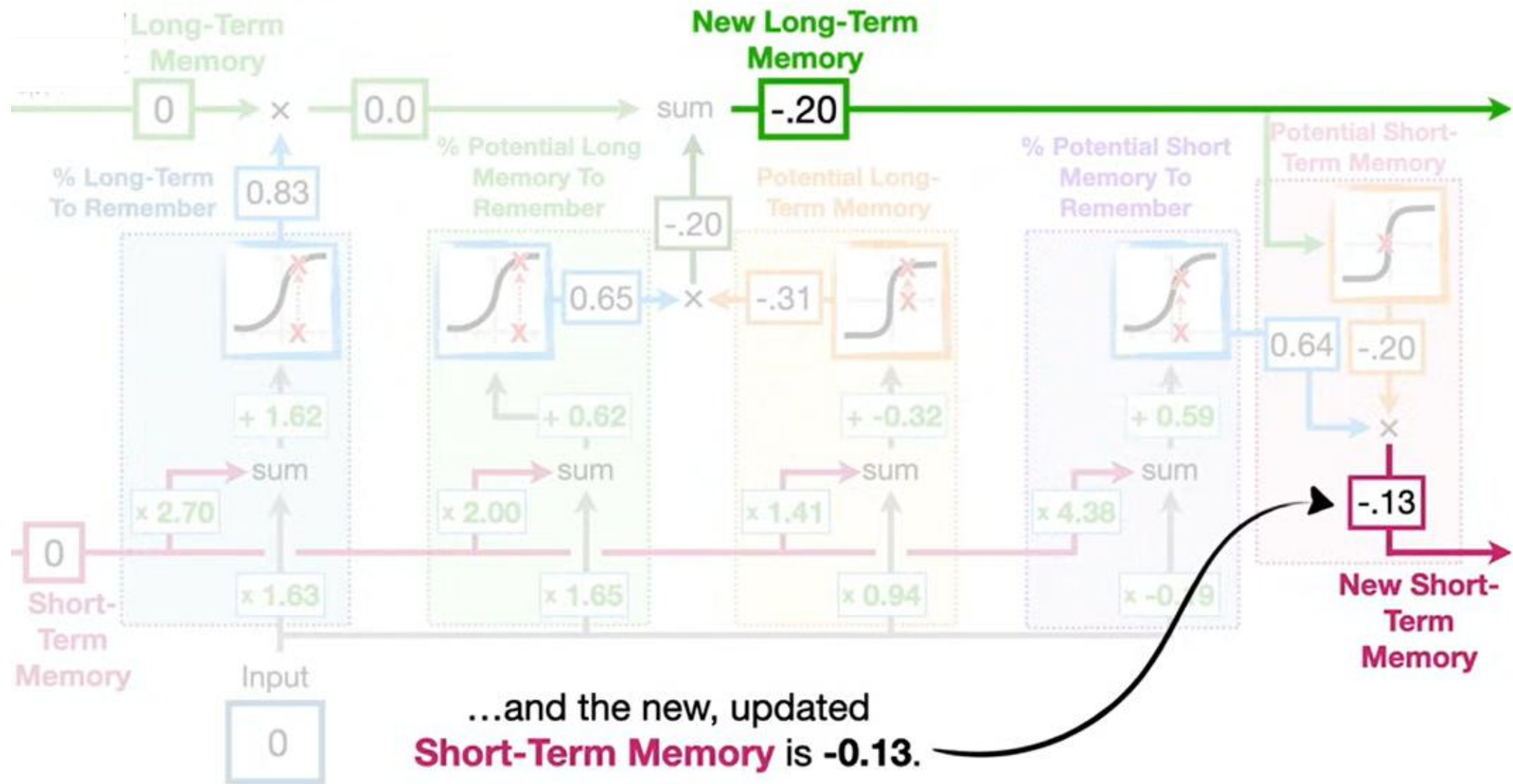


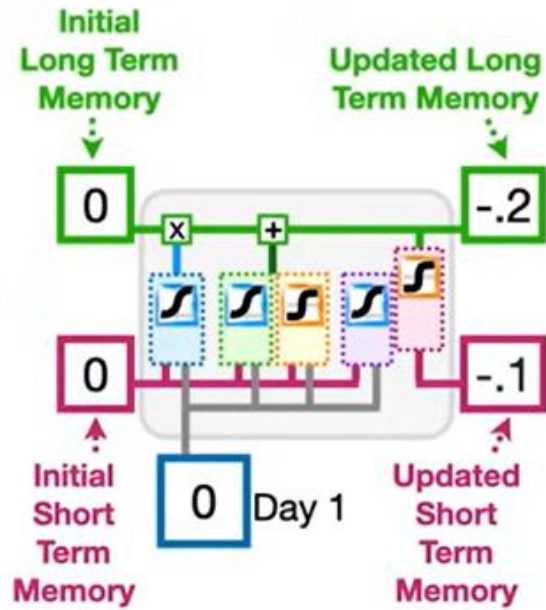
The only difference is at day 1 and day 5... we want the LSTM to remember what happened on day 1 to predict what will happen in day 5



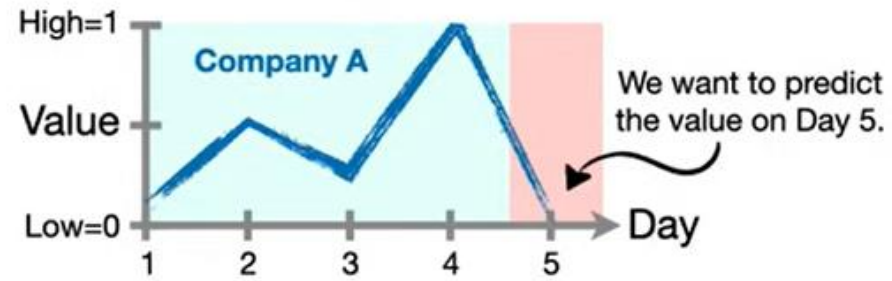


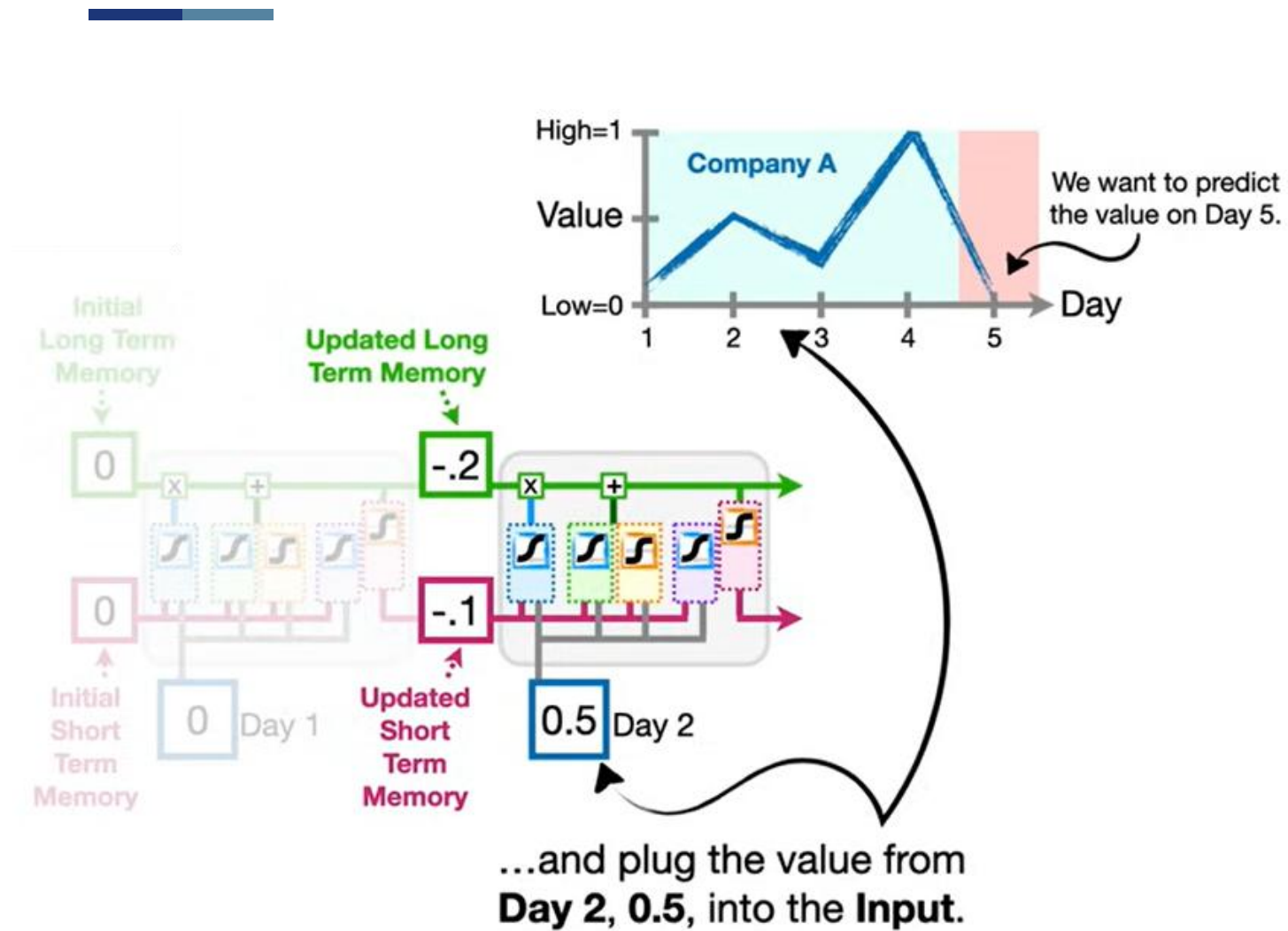
Now, if we want to sequentially run **Company A**'s values from **Days 1** through **4** through this **LSTM**...

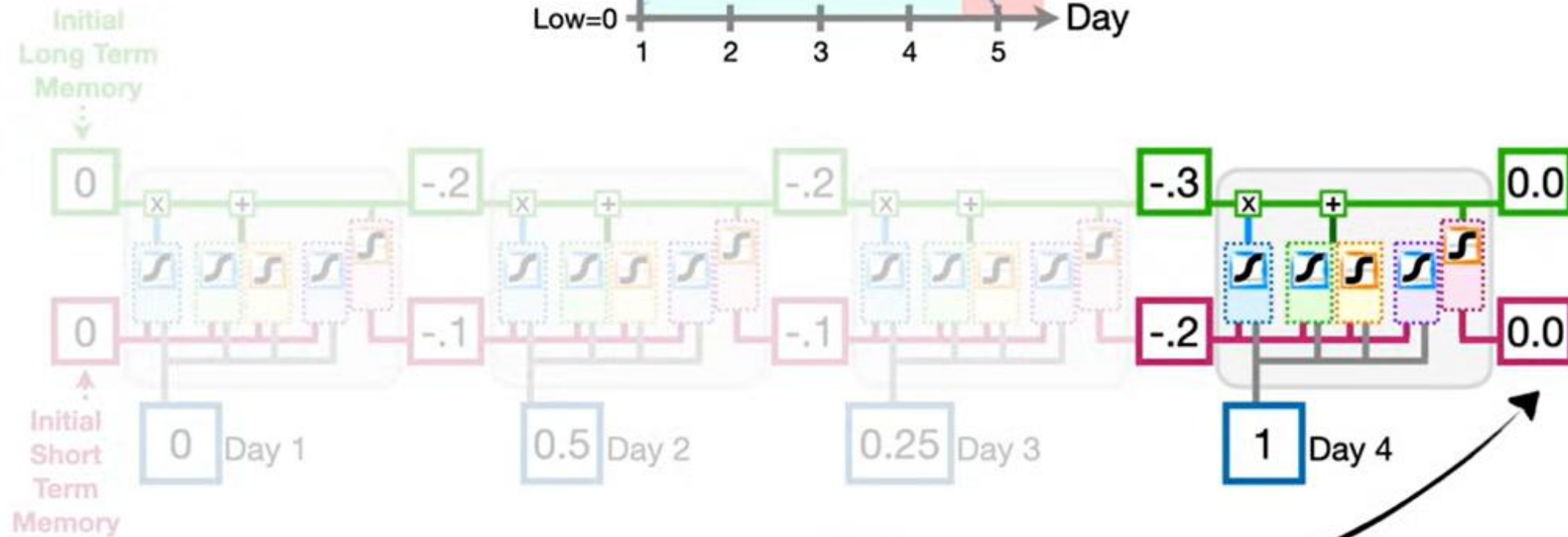
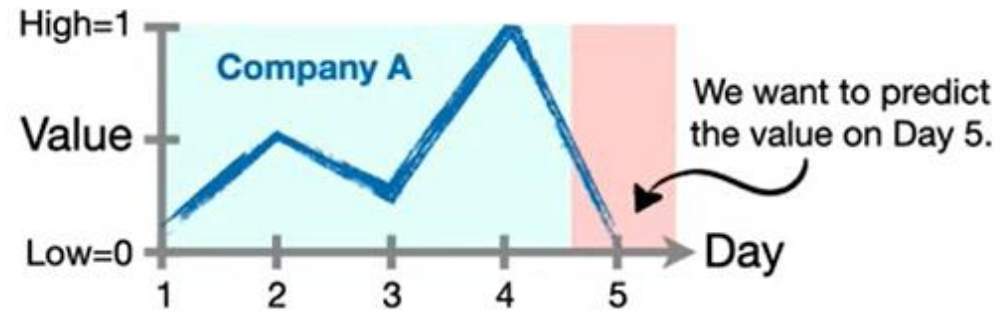




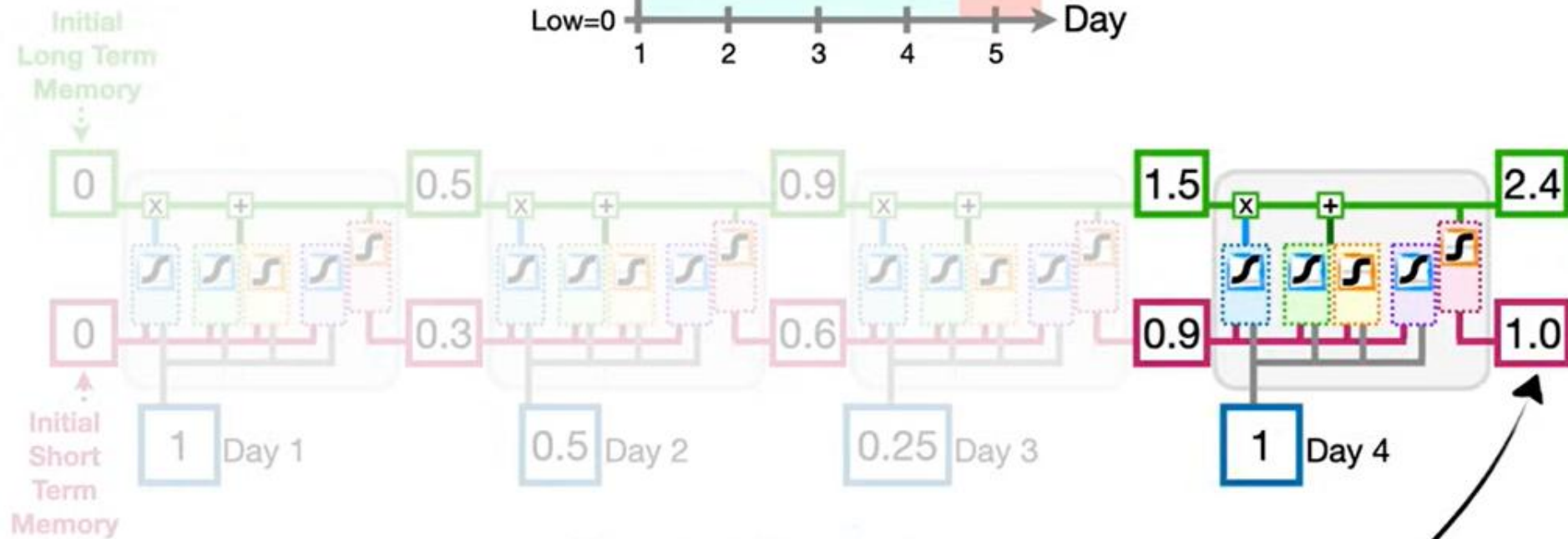
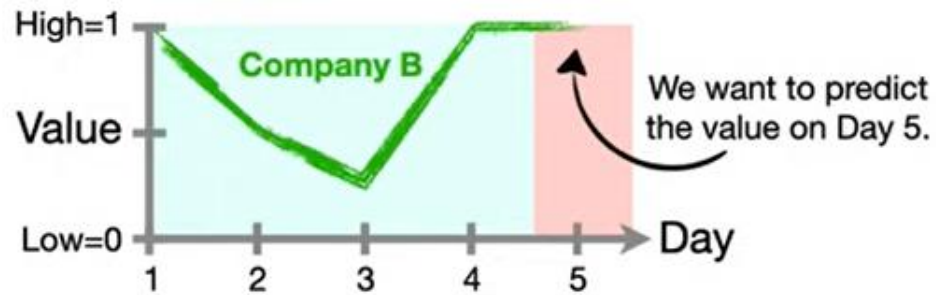
...and **-0.1** (rounded) for the updated **Short-Term Memory**.







And the final **Short-Term Memory**, **0.0**, is the **Output** from the unrolled **LSTM**.



...and the final **Short-Term Memory**, 1.0, is the **Output** from the **unrolled LSTM**.